

Business Requirements



INTERGRATED MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

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VERSION CONTROL

VERSION 1	DATE	SECTION UPDATE	DESCRIPTION
1.1	2025/09/17	Current state	
1.2	2025/10/09	Stakeholders, RACI, Scope, To-Be, Functional Requirements	Incorporated Risk & Governance department feedback: added governance as stakeholder; updated RACI consult list; enhanced reporting dashboards, pipelines, performance automation, and tranche rules; added Governance-linked reporting.
1.3	2025/10/09	Requirements	System checks if SDL number exists.(if yes, system prompts user to link instead of creating duplicates.)
1.4	2025/10/14	Functional Requirements (Funding Window & SDF Registration)	Refined Funding Window requirements: added project type, executive approval, SLA/APP links, clarified notifications. Enhanced SDF Registration: added ID verification, SDL validation, primary/secondary logic, and change request workflow.
1.5	2025/10/15	Functional Requirements – Funding Window, Tranche Payments, Integration & Data Requirements; User Journey – Finance Payment Approval	• Added “Expenditure ceiling (linked to Board-approved budget)” under Funding Window configuration. • Expanded Tranche Payments section to include “POPs will be uploaded as a batch to the GMU with access for distribution to stakeholders.” • Added new Business Rule: “System should not allow payments exceeding total contract value.” • Added “Finance will grant access to GMU” under Integration – Finance System. • Under User Journey (Finance Payment Approval): included new Finance inputs — flagging changed banking details, import of payment batches and supplier data via SAGE integration, and remittance submission to Grants.
1.6	2025/20/30	Functional requirements	DG Awards, Payment Processing, Change Requests, MOA Extension, Sweeps, Recoveries, Commitment Schedule) with system requirements.

2.2	2025/10/30	Process Flow / Business Logic	Added detailed end-to-end DG workflow stages for Awards, Payment Processing, Change Requests, MOA Extension, Sweeps, and Recoveries, including IMS automation points.
2.3	2025/10/30	Roles & Responsibilities	Expanded stakeholder roles to include Grants Practitioner, Grants Specialist, Regional Skills Advisor, SQMR Specialist, and Executive Manager per new SOPs.
2.4	2025/10/30	Integration & Dependencies	Linked Grants modules with Finance (commitment schedule auto-sync), ICT (system alerts, digital signatures), and Risk & Governance (performance assurance).
2.5	2025/10/30	Scope of Work	Broadened to include full Grants lifecycle automation: DG advertising, evaluation, approval, extension, sweeping, recovery, and reporting.
2.6	2025/11/04	Functional requirements	Corporate services added on tranche deliverables
2.7	2025/11/04	Scope/to-be	Risk and governance defined their pipelines.
2.8	2025/11/04	Functional Requirements	Integration of the Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) system into IMS, including dashboards, workflows, performance indicators and evidence tracking. Added Online Assessment Platform integration (UJ system) requirements, ETQA-linked learner validation processes, expanded OCR validation, and updated system dependencies.
2.9	2025/11/26	Functional Requirements	Added new AoPO/Performance Management module covering APP indicator configuration, DG-to-indicator mapping, regional performance validation workflows, integration with SETMIS/SurveyHub/ETQA, performance evidence rules, quarterly reporting workflow, DHET/AGSA export compliance, audit trail and validation rules.
2.10	2025/11/16	Functional Requirements	Added full Mandatory Grants (MG) module including funding window setup, SDF registration and dispute workflow, MG application capture, MG evaluation workflow (RSA → Regional Manager → Grants Manager → Executive Manager → Grants Committee), MG extension requests, MG business rules, and MG process flow diagrams.

SUMMARY

The Integrated Management System (IMS) project will digitize and streamline CHIETA's Grants management processes, **as well as other business unit processes**. Currently, these processes — from opening grant windows to contract initiation, learner enrolment, tranche payments, monitoring, and close-out — are highly manual, Excel-based, and prone to delays, duplication, and compliance risks.

The IMS system will provide a single, automated platform that manages the **full CHIETA data and process** lifecycle, supports compliance with PFMA, Pop IA, Auditor-General (AG), and SIU requirements, and improves efficiency and transparency across CHIETA's Grants, **Corporate Services**, Finance, and Regional Skills Advisor (RSA) teams and other business units.

The IMS will be developed in line with CHIETA's **Software Development Standards** and the data management policy delivered through **Agile methodology**, ensuring iterative releases, collaboration with cross-functional teams, and alignment with evolving business needs.

This BRD documents the business context, scope, functional and non-functional requirements, business rules, reporting needs, risks, and success criteria for the IMS system. It will serve as the foundation for design, development, testing, and implementation.

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SUMMARY

Key Outcomes of the IMS:

- Flexible opening and management of Grant funding windows.
- Management of data and all business unit processes
- Automated contract initiation, MoA management, and tranche scheduling (1a, 1b, 2, and/or 3).
- Real-time reconciliation between Finance and Regional offices.
- Standardized monitoring and evaluation templates, aligned to AG/SIU requirements.
- Secure stakeholder portal for SDF/organisation incumbent registration, organisation linking, applications, and uploads.
- Workflow-driven evaluation process (Regional/Departmental (Would be both CS and Research & Skills Planning Department) → Grants Evaluation Committee → Grants Adjudication Committee → Grants Committee).
- Automated handling of appeals, change requests, and contract withdrawals.
- Dynamic dashboards and reporting, for different core business functions, including commitment schedules, WSP/ATR submissions, Qualifications' usage, ETQA providers, workplace approvals, certification payment reports, and learner statistics

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KEYWORDS

1. Agile

A flexible, iterative software development methodology promoting collaboration and continuous delivery.

2. Audit/Review

Independent assessments of systems for compliance with standards and specifications.

3. AG (Auditor-General)

Independent body that audits CHIETA's processes and reports.

4. Appeal

Process by which a stakeholder can challenge or request a review of a rejected Discretionary Grant (DG) application

5. APP (Annual Performance Plan)

Annual plan outlining CHIETA's performance targets, aligned to SLA.

6. Commitment Schedule

A financial schedule showing committed grant funds, payments made, and remaining balances.

7. DG (Discretionary Grant)

Funding approved by the CHIETA Board for strategic and learning projects, allocated during DG funding windows.

8. Funding Window

A specific period during which stakeholders can submit applications for DG funding (e.g., DG/2025/Cycle 1).

9. GAC (Grants Adjudication Committee)

CHIETA committee responsible for reviewing and finalizing DG recommendations.

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KEYWORDS

10. Grants Practitioner / Specialist / Manager / Executive

Roles within the CHIETA Business Unit responsible for evaluating, recommending, and approving DG applications and tranche payments.

11. GEC (Grants Evaluation Committee)

Committee that evaluates DG recommendations from the regional level before they go to GAC.

12. ICT

Information and Communications Technology; the department responsible for managing CHIETA's systems.

13. IMS (Integrated Management System)

The new digital system being developed to automate DG processes.

14. Learner Schedule

List of learners enrolled under a DG project, including IDs, contracts, and qualifications.

15. MoA (Memorandum of Agreement)

Contract between CHIETA and a grant recipient, signed before funding is released.

16. MoSCoW Prioritisation

Method of ranking requirements as Must, Should, Could, or Won't.

17. Monitoring & Evaluation

Activities to check learner progress, verify documents, and ensure funds are used correctly (includes site visits and interviews).

18. OCR (Optical Character Recognition)

Technology used by IMS to validate scanned documents.

19. PFMA (Public Finance Management Act)

Legislation governing financial management at CHIETA.

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KEYWORDS

20. PFMA (Public Finance Management Act)

Legislation governing financial management at CHIETA.

21. PoPIA (Protection of Personal Information Act)

Law regulating personal data protection in South Africa.

22. RSA (Regional Skills Advisor)

CHIETA staff member responsible for evaluating DG applications, conducting site visits, and monitoring learners.

23. SDF (Skills Development Facilitator)

Person assisting companies with DG applications, learner enrolment, and reporting.

24. SDL (Skills Development Levy)

Levy paid by companies to fund training; used to determine eligibility for DG funding.

25. SETMIS (Skills Education Training Management Information System)

National reporting system for learner and training data.

26. SLA (Service Level Agreement)

Agreement between CHIETA and the Department of Higher Education & Training, setting targets for skills development.

27. Tranche Payments :

Staged payments made to grant recipients:

- **Tranche 1a:** On MoA signing.
- **Tranche 1b:** On learner enrolment.
- **Tranche 2:** On mid-term monitoring.
- **Tranche 3:** On completion/certification.

28. UAT (User Acceptance Testing)

Final testing phase where business users verify that IMS meets requirements before go-live.

29. Workflow

Automated sequence of tasks, approvals, and notifications in IMS.

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BUSINESS CONTEXT



The Chemical Industries Education and Training Authority (CHIETA) manages Grant funding to support skills development in line with the, SSP Annual Performance Plan (APP) and Service Level Agreement (SLA) with the Department of Higher Education and Training.

Currently, grant management processes (applications, evaluations, payments, monitoring, and reporting) are highly manual, relying on Excel sheets, emails, and multiple levels of approval. This creates duplication, delays, audit risks, and difficulty in reconciling financial data between Business units and Finance teams.

Business Priorities & Objectives

- Automate end-to-end DG and MG management through IMS.
- Improve turnaround times for DG application, approval, and payment.
- Improve turnaround times for WSP/ATR submissions and approvals, including MG payments
- Enhance compliance with PFMA, PoPIA, AG, and other applicable legislations.
- Standardize monitoring and evaluation processes.
- Enable real-time data, financial tracking and reconciliation.
- Provide dashboards and reports for management and executives.

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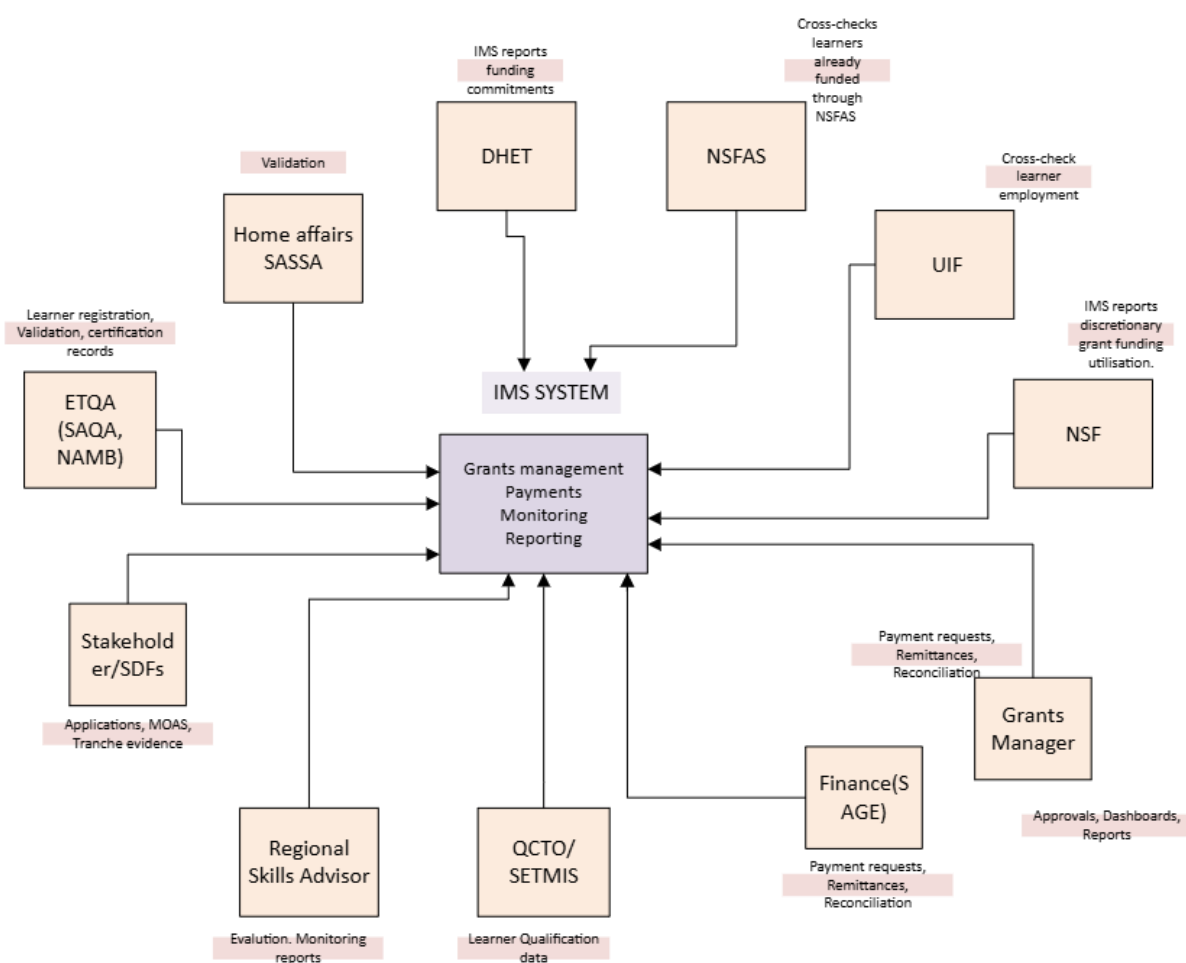
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IMS CONTEXT DIAGRAM



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STAKEHOLDERS

Internal Stakeholders:

Grants Adjudication Committee (GAC) – Reviews recommendations from GEC; ensures alignment with APP and budget before approval.

Grants Evaluation Committee (GEC) – Evaluates recommendations from Regional Committees and validates against budgets.

CEO & Executive: Grants – Oversees DG processes, appoints committee members, approves high-level recommendations.

ETQA - Oversees accreditation and quality assurance for learning programmes. Capture/Update learner registration, provider accreditation, assessment centre accreditation, trade test centre accreditation, workplace approval, workplace endorsements, certification, registration of constituent assessors and moderators, quality assurance of learner achievements, and replacement processes.

Regional and other Administrators – Receive and allocate DG applications; handle SDF disputes; oversee application workflow in regions.

RSA and other practitioners – Evaluate DG applications, check workplace approvals, conduct monitoring visits, and verify documents.

ICT / IMS Development Team – Build and maintain the IMS platform, ensuring compliance with security and development standards.

Finance Team (Admin, Practitioner, Manager, CFO) – Verify payments against MoAs and tranche evidence, approve requisitions, generate payment files, integrate with SAGE.

Audit & Compliance (AG, SIU) Oversight to ensure PFMA, SLA, and APP compliance.

Research & Skills Planning Unit – Responsible for conducting, commissioning, and monitoring research studies; managing sectoral data; and supporting M&E and APP

STAKEHOLDERS

External Stakeholders:

Skills Development Facilitators (SDFs) and other stakeholders – Register on IMS, link companies, prepare and submit DG applications.

Levy-Paying Companies – Apply for DGs, host learners, provide supporting compliance documents.

Non-Levy-Paying & Exempted Organisations – Eligible for specific DG funding opportunities.

Skills Development Providers/ Assessment Centres and Trade test Centres/ Employers – Host and train learners, provide progress and completion reports.

Learners – Beneficiaries of DG-funded programmes; enrol and complete **qualifications and learners on the SSDD platform**

Department of Higher Education & Training (DHET) – Policy oversight and SLA reporting.

QCTO/SETA – **Provides learner registration, assessment, certification**, accreditation, qualification, Quality Assurance Council, responsible for QQSF on the National Qualification Framework

SETA – Sector Education and Training Authority, facilitating Skills development in a specific sector.

Home Affairs – ID validation for learners.

SASSA - Validate if learner is receiving social grants

National Skills Fund (NSF) -IMS reports discretionary grant funding utilisation.

NSFAS - Cross-checks learners already funded through NSFAS

UIF -Cross-check learner employment/unemployment status.

NAMB - **Assessment Quality partner, responsible for the Quality assurance of Trade related Occupational Qualifications and Legacy Trades .**

DHET - reports funding commitments, disbursements, and learner data to DHET

SAQA - South African Qualifications Authority, responsible for the registration of Qualifications.

Governance & Risk – Performance Monitoring & Evaluation, Oversight, Reporting

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RACI MATRIX

Process Stage	Responsible (R)	Accountable (A)	Consulted (C)	Informed (I)
Open DG Window	Grants Manager	Executive: Grants, SDF	Grants Committee. ETQA	Companies
SDF/ Stakeholder Registration & Company Linking	SDF/ Stakeholder, Regional and other Admin	Grants Manager, Regional Team and other relevant role players	ICT (IMS Support), DHET (SDL data), Home Affairs (ID checks)	RSA, Finance
DG Application Submission	SDF / Stakeholder	Company Representative	RSA and other practitioners and specialists (guidance), ETQA	Regional Manager and other Managers
Application Evaluation	Regional Skills Advisors and other practitioners and specialists (RSAs)	Regional Admin and other	Grants Manager and other Managers, Compliance, ETQA	SDF, Company
Regional Recommendation	Regional Admin and other relevant role players	Grants Manager and other Managers	RSAs, RSA peers, Regional Managers and other relevant role players	GEC
Grants Evaluation Committee (GEC)	GEC Members	CEO	Regional Admin, Grants Manager, Regional Managers, ETQA and other	GAC
Grants Adjudication Committee (GAC)	GAC Members	Grants Committee	CEO, GEC	SDFs
Final Approval	Grants Committee	Board	CEO	Grants Executive, Companies
MoA & Contracting	RSA and other practitioners and specialists, SDF and Stakeholders	Grants Manager	Grants Practitioner, ETQA	Company
Tranche 1a (MoA Signing)	RSA and other practitioners and specialists, SDF and Stakeholders	Grants Manager	CEO	Company, Regional Manager and other relevant role players
Tranche 1b (Learner Enrolment)	RSA and other practitioners and specialists, SDF and Stakeholders, Finance	Grants Manager	SDF	Finance, Grants, Research & Skills
Tranche 2 (Mid-term Monitoring)	RSA and other practitioners and specialists, SDF and Stakeholders, Finance	Grants Manager	SDF	Finance, Grants, Research & Skills and other relevant role players
Tranche 3 (Close-out / Completion)	RSA and other practitioners and specialists, SDF and Stakeholders, Finance	Grants Manager	SDF	Finance, Grants, Research & Skills and other relevant role players

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Change Requests	SDF / Stakeholders, RSA, and other relevant role players	Grants Manager and the relevant Manager	Grants Executive	Company
Payments (All Tranches)	Finance Admin, Finance Practitioner, and other role players who process payments	CFO	Grants Manager, Grants Executive and the other Executives	Company, SDF, National Skills Fund (NSF)
Monitoring & Evaluation	RSA, Practitioners and Specialists	SDF / Stakeholders	Compliance, Audit	Executive: Grants, Risk & Compliance and other Executives
Reporting (SLA, APP, SETMIS, Dashboards)	Grants Manager, ICT and other role players	CEO	Finance, Compliance, DHET, SAQA, QCTO, NSFAS, Dept. of Labour / UIF, SASSA, NSF, ETQA	Board, Committees, Stakeholders

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RACI MATRIX - GRANTS

PROCESS STAGE	RESPONSIBLE	ACCOUNTABLE	CONSULTED	INFORMED
Opening DG Window	Grants Manager	Exec: Grants	Manco	Companies
SDF Registration and linking company	SDF, Regional Admin	Regional Manager	ICT (IMS Support) DHET, SDL DATA, Home affairs, OD Checks	RSA
DG Application submission	SDF, Company representative	Company Senior Rep	ICT, IMS Support	Regional Manager SDF
DG Application submission	SDF	Company Representative	RSA(Guidance)saka (Qualification match) QCTO (Accreditation) NAMB (Trade Tests)	Regional Manager
Regional Recommendation	RSAs	Regional Manager	Grants Manager ETQA ICT Team	DG Applicants GEC
Grants Evaluation Committee	GEC Members	GEC Chair	Grants Manager Regional Manager CEO	GAC Grants Committee
Grants Adjudication Committee	GAC Members	GAC Chair	Grants Manager Regional Manager CEO	GAC Grants Committee
Final Approval	Grants Committee	Governing Board	CEO	Manco
MOA Drafting	SQMR Specialist	Grants Manager	ICT Team ETQA Regions	Executives
Tranche 1A(MOA Submission)	Regional Admin and RSA Practitioners & Specialists	Regional Manager Grants Manager	Executive Grants	CFO & Finance CEO Board committees
Tranche 1B (Learner enrolment)	Regional Admin and RSA Practitioners & Specialists	Regional Manager Grants Manager	Executive Grants	CFO & Finance CEO Board committees
Tranche 2 (Midterm reporting)	Regional Admin and RSA Practitioners & Specialists	Regional Manager Grants Manager	Executive Grants	CFO & Finance CEO Board committees

Tranche 3 (Close out Report)	Regional Admin and RSA Practitioners & Specialists	Regional Manager Grants Manager	Executive Grants	CFO & Finance CEO Board committees
Change request	RSA	Regional Manager	Companies SQMR Specialist Grants Manager Grants Executive	Executive Grants Governance, Risk and compliance
Adjustments (Withdrawals, Sweeps & Extensions)	RSA	Regional Manager	Companies SQMR Specialist Grants Manager Grants Executive	Executive Grants Governance, Risk and compliance
Payments (All Tranches)	Finance Admin Finance Practitioner	CFO	Grants Manager Grants Executive	Companies SDFs
Monitoring evaluation	RSA	Regional Manager	Auditors Companies	Executive Grants Governance, Risk and compliance
Reporting (SLA, APP, SETMIS, Dashboards)	SQMR Specialist Governance & Risk Specialist	Grants Manager Governance & Risk manager	Finance, Compliance, DHET, SAQA, QCTO, NAMB, NSFAS, Dept of Labour/UIF, SASSA, NSF	Board, Committees, Stakeholders

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SCOPE

I. In Scope

- Management of DG and MG Applications: submission, evaluation, approval, adjudication.
 - i. MG (WSP/ATR)
 - ii. Skills Supply and Demand Database (SSDD)
 - iii. Qualifications
 - iv. ETQA
 - v. M&E
- SDF Registration & Company Linking (new and existing organizations).
- Funding Window Management (opening, parameters, categories, interventions).
- Change Requests & Appeals (post-award modifications).
- MoA & Contract Management (generation, signing, uploads, verification).
- Tranche Payments (1a, 1b, 2, and/or 3) and Sweeping of unused funds.
- Monitoring & Evaluation (site visits, mid-term reports, close-out checks).
- Notifications & Alerts (emails, system messages for key milestones).
- Integration with key systems:
 - i. Finance system (SAGE) for payment processing & reconciliation.
 - ii. SETMIS reporting for learners.
 - iii. Home Affairs for ID validation.
 - iv. QCTO/SETA for learner qualification validation.
- Reporting Dashboards: Commitments, tranches, due payment tracking, SLA/APP reporting (Performance Scorecard: achievement vs target – variance)
- Pipelines: From commitments and payment reconciliation to performance, pipeline numbers highlighting entries and completions.
- Audit & Compliance (document uploads, version control, PoPIA compliance).
- Integration of external entities (eg. NAMB, UIF etc)
- Integration with ETQA system.

SCOPE



II. Out of Scope

- Non-grant related CHIETA systems (e.g., internal HR, Procurement).
- Direct training delivery — IMS will not deliver training, only manage grants.
- Legacy grant applications (applications submitted outside the IMS before go-live will not be migrated, unless specifically agreed).

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ASSUMPTIONS & CONSTRAINTS

Assumptions

- Stakeholders (SDFs, Employers, Training Providers) will have reliable internet access to use the IMS.
- All applicants will register as SDFs and stakeholders before submitting DG applications.
- Finance system (SAGE) integration will be available and supported by CHIETA's Finance team.
- SETMIS, Home Affairs, and QCTO systems will provide access to APIs or bulk upload facilities for validation.
- Users will be trained on how to use IMS prior to go-live.
- Required budgets (Discretionary Grants allocations) will be approved annually by the Board/Grants Committee.
- MoA/**addenda** and contract templates will be standardized and provided by the Grants Unit.
- ICT team will maintain hosting, backup, and security compliance in line with CHIETA Software Development Standards.
- **TQA integration will be maintained for data accuracy.**

Constraints

- IMS must comply with PoPIA (data privacy) and PFMA (public funds management).
- Only approved budget ceilings can be allocated — IMS cannot exceed available funds.
- System must follow CHIETA's Software Development Standards (SDLC, coding, testing, documentation).
- Learner and stakeholder data will be subject to verification (bank details, tax compliance, accreditation, **workplace approvals, workplace endorsements**).
- Project timelines may be limited by availability of funding and stakeholder readiness.
- Changes to requirements after sign-off will go through formal Change Control.
- **IMS will not replace external systems (e.g. SAGE, Home Affairs, QCTO)**

AS-IS PROCESS



Current SOP Overview (Payment Processing & DG Applications)

- Applications for Discretionary Grants (DGs) are submitted manually (emails, physical forms, Excel templates).
- Regional offices and Grants Unit use Excel and emails to track applications, approvals, and payments.
- Evaluations are handled manually by Regional Skills Advisors (RSAs) with limited system support.
- Approvals go through multiple committees (Regional Recommendation, GEC, GAC, Grants Committee).
- Memorandum of Agreement (MoA) is drafted and signed manually; tracking relies on uploads/emails.
- Tranche payments (1a, 1b, 2, 3) are managed manually via Finance using SAGE; reconciliation with Regions requires manual checks.
- Monitoring & Evaluation is performed by site visits, paper-based checklists, and emailed progress reports.
- Reporting is fragmented — commitments, payments, and learner progress are consolidated manually for SLA/APP reporting.

Challenges

- Heavy reliance on Excel and emails → high risk of errors, duplication, and delays.
- Manual reconciliation between Finance and Regions causes inconsistencies.
- Tracking multiple tranches and learner progress is time-consuming and prone to missing deadlines.
- Lack of real-time visibility of commitments vs. payments.
- Audit risks due to scattered documents and lack of centralized version control.
- No integrated notifications/reminders for stakeholders or internal staff.
- Limited reporting capability — requires manual collation of data for management reports.

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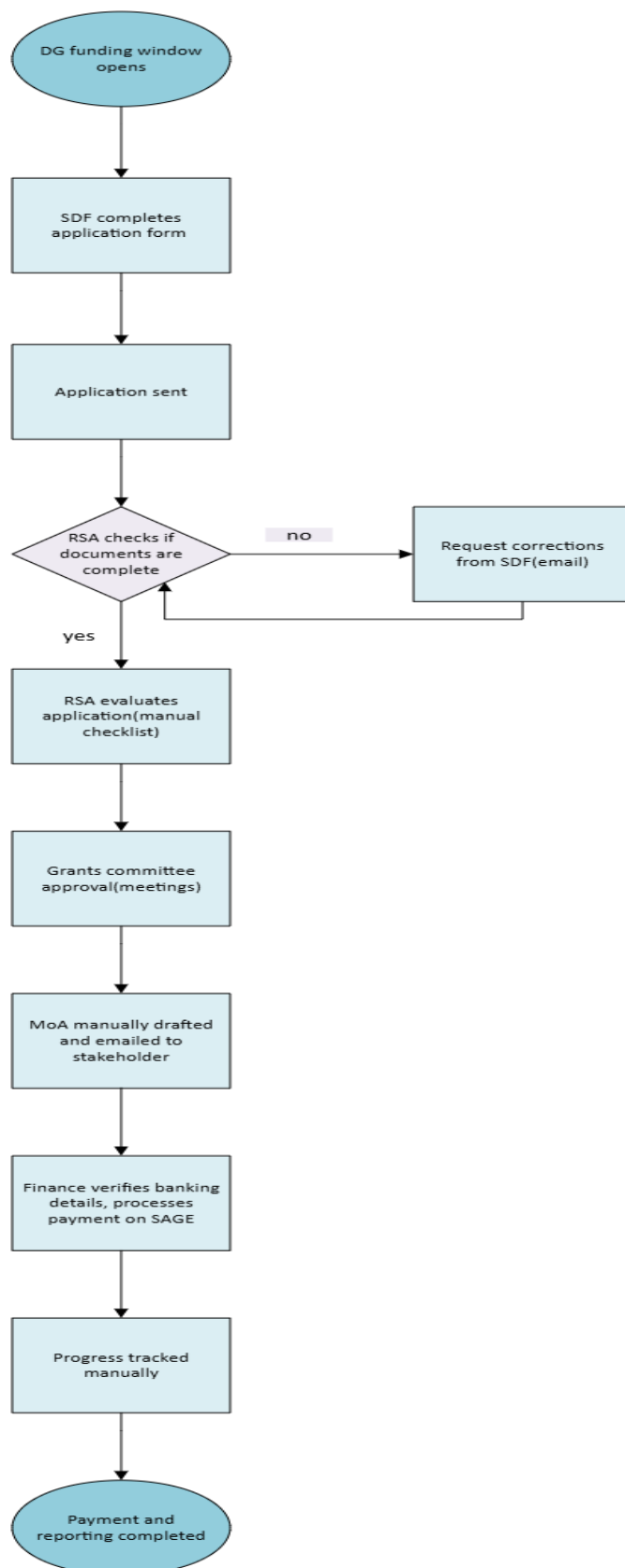
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AS-IS

PROCESS FLOW



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TO BE PROCESS



To-Be Process (IMS)

- IMS will digitize the full CHIETA and Discretionary Grants (DG) lifecycle.
- Stakeholders (SDFs, Employers, companies, Training , Skills development Providers) will apply directly through IMS.
- The system will manage funding windows, evaluations, approvals, payments, learner enrolments, learner completions, learner certifications and monitoring and other business units core processes in one central platform.
- IMS will automate CHIETA performance reporting against APP and pipelines.
- Integration with Finance (SAGE), SETMIS, Home Affairs, and ETQA ensures real-time validation and reporting.
- Notifications and alerts will guide stakeholders and CHIETA staff through each process step.
- Dashboards will provide real-time data, tracking of commitments, payments, and learner progress, and will also include the performance dashboard across all four programmes.
- IMS to integrate Business Unit risk registers to monitor the control environment within the approved governance and risk appetite.
- IMS must allow updates to risk controls to provide adequate assurance levels.

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Key Improvements Over As-Is

- Automated application capture and digital submission.
- Centralized evaluation workflow with automated allocation to Regional Skills Advisors, including other relevant positions within CHIETA.
- Committee meetings (Regional and other business units Recommendation, GEC, GAC, Grants Committee) supported by system-generated agendas, scoring, and outcomes tracking.
- MoAC Contract Management with electronic document generation, uploads, and version control.
- Automated tranche payment workflow with evidence uploads, RSA and Business Units verification, Finance approval, and integration to SAGE.
- Monitoring & Evaluation with system-generated checklists, progress reporting, and learner interviews linked to applications. (Incorporating the M&E tool that was developed by the M&E partner contracted by RSPU and presented to IT and Grants on 24/10/2025)
- Built-in change request C appeals process to handle post-award modifications.
- Real-time reconciliation between Business Units, Regional Offices and Finance, reducing audit risks.
- Automated notifications C reminders to stakeholders at key milestones (window opening, MoA signing, payment due, progress reporting, qualifications expiry dates, close-out).
- Access to disaggregated data for analysis
- Reporting C Dashboards to track commitments, tranches due, payment tracking, SLA/APP alignment, and learner outcomes.
- Integration with the ETQA system

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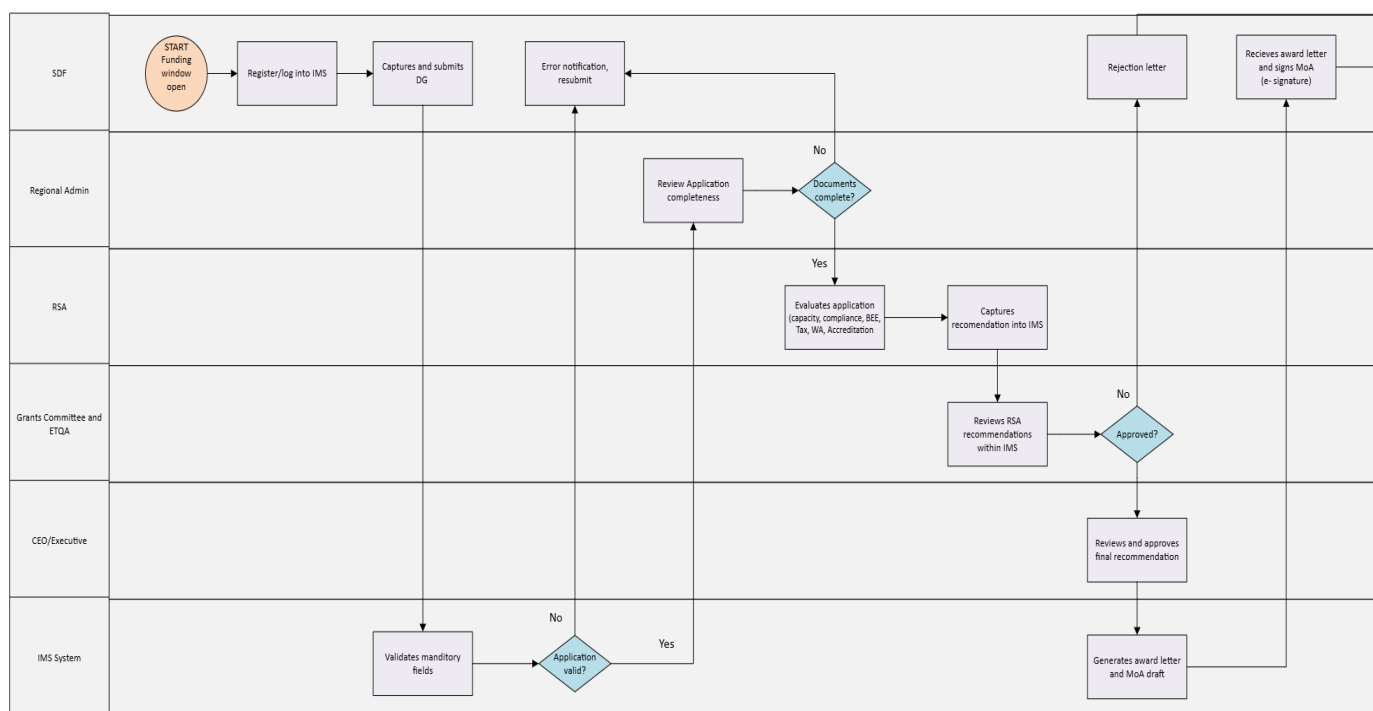
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DG APPLICATION AND EVALUTION



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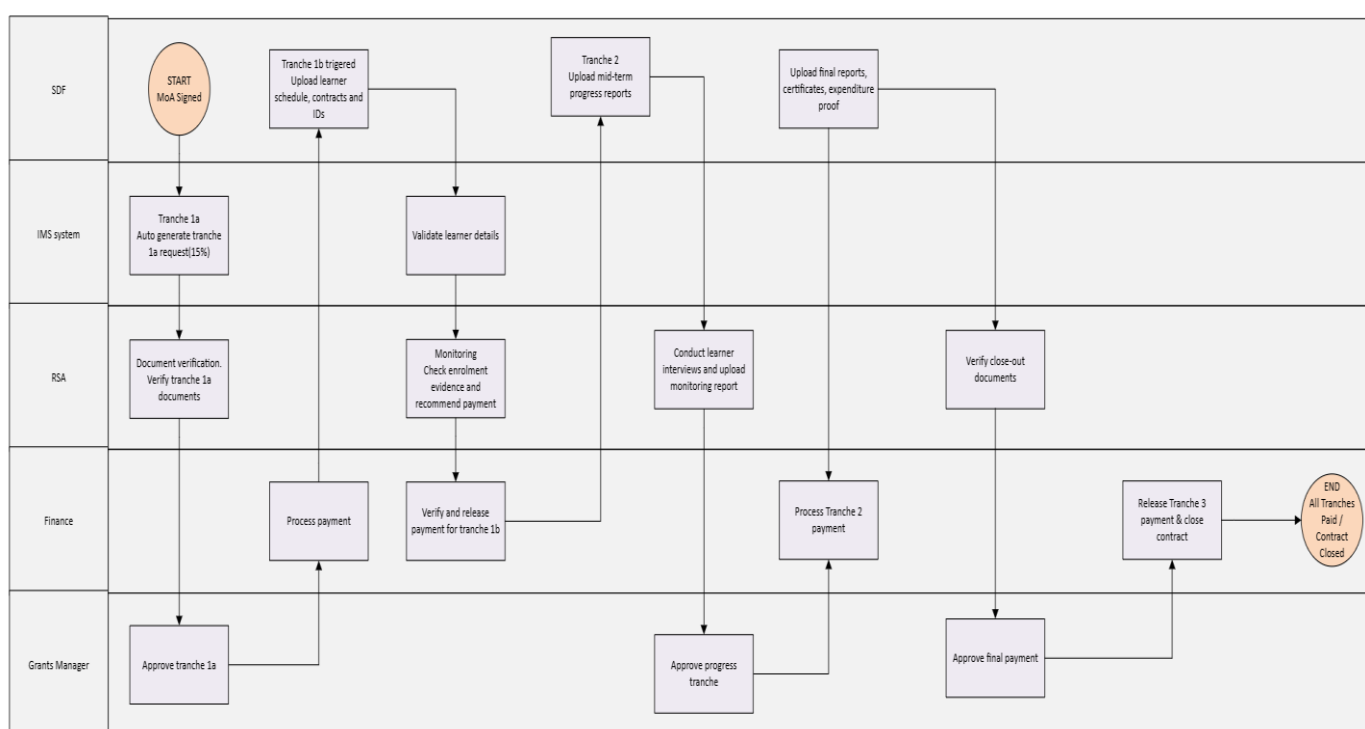
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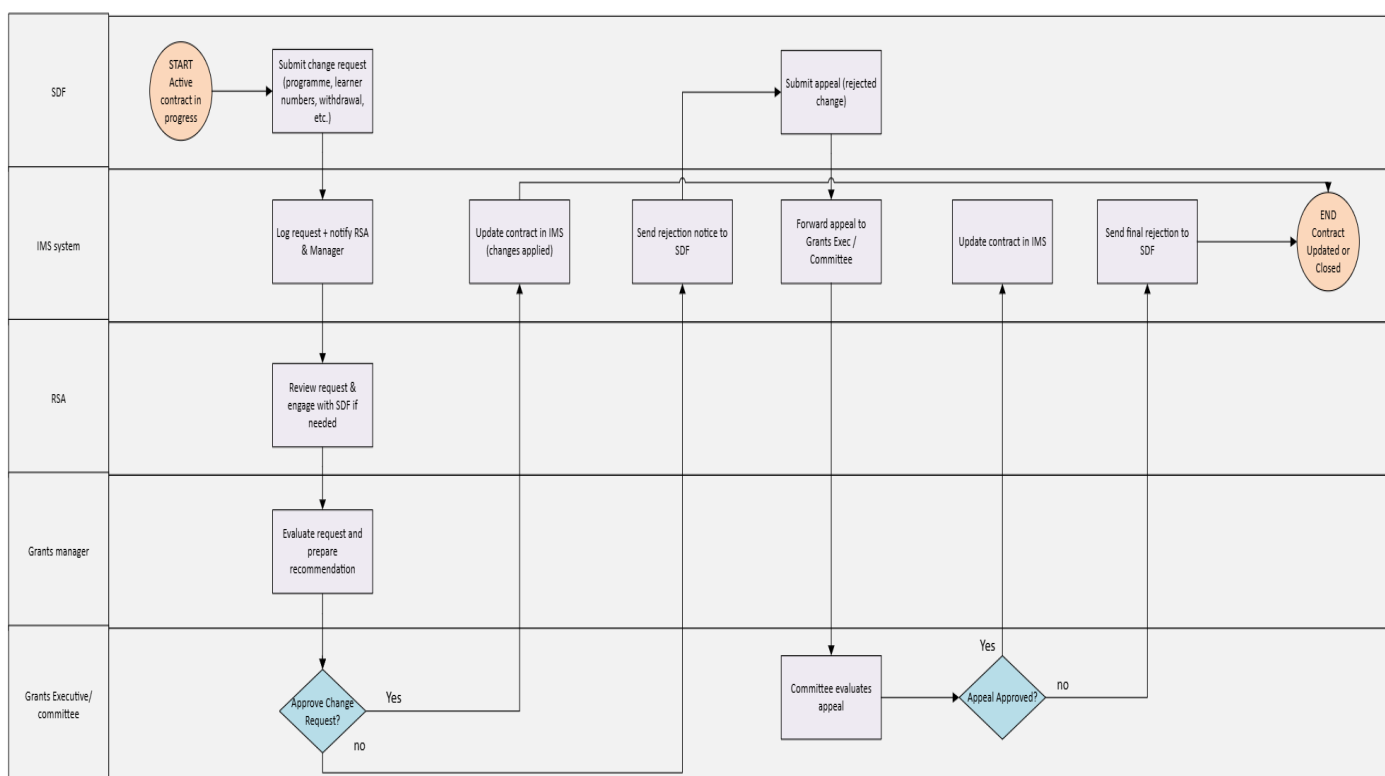
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TRANCHE PAYMENTS (1A, 1B, 2, 3)



CHANGE REQUESTS & APPEALS



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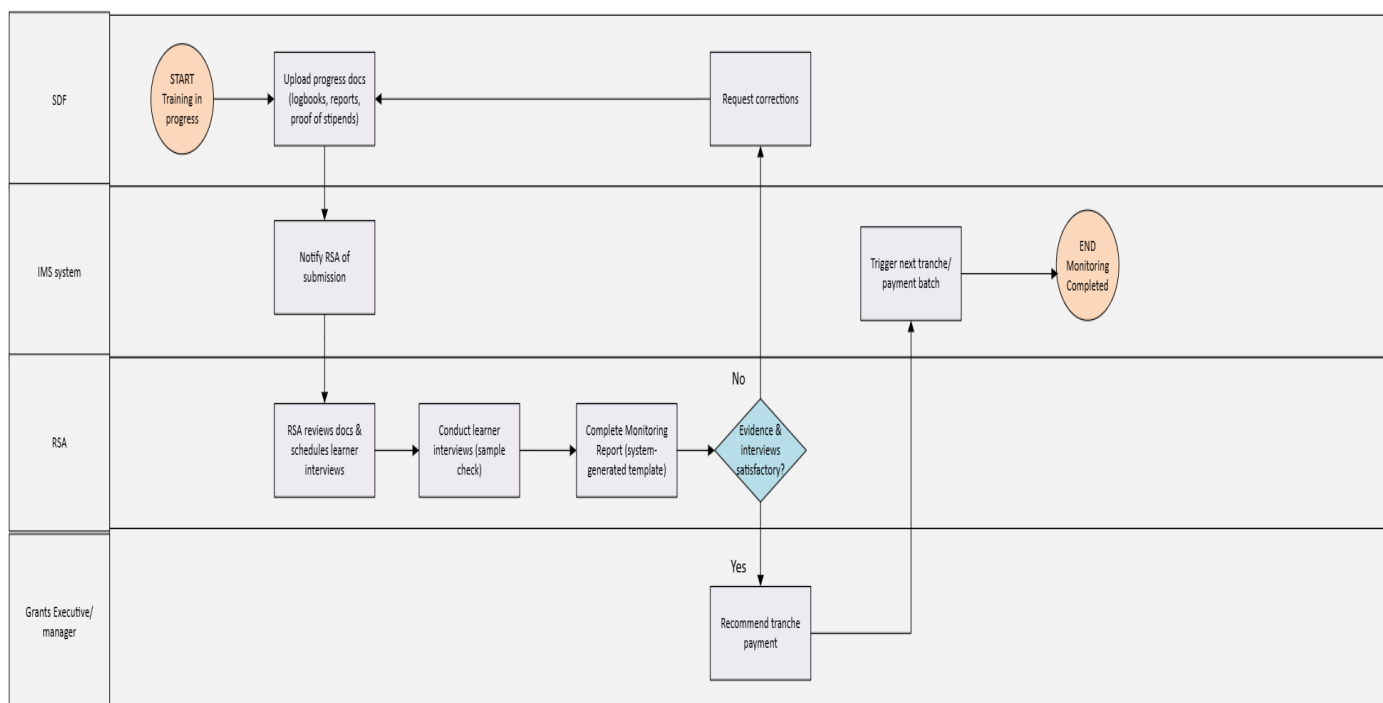
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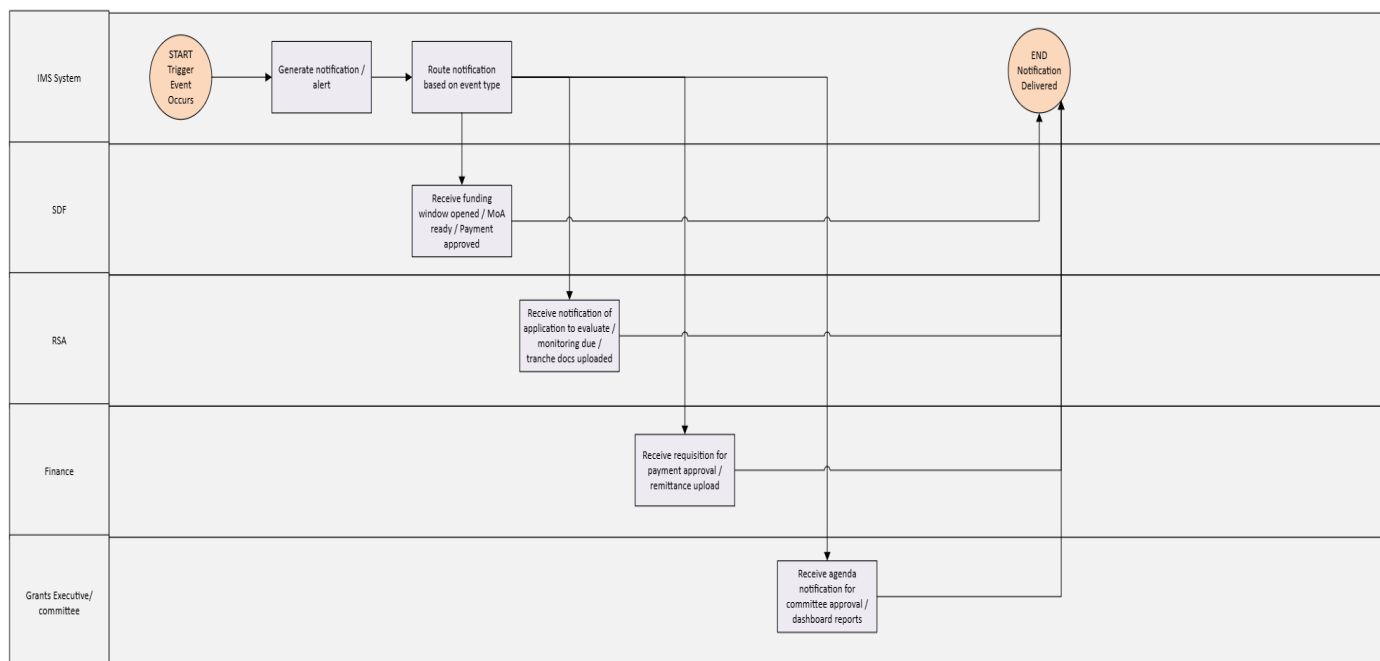
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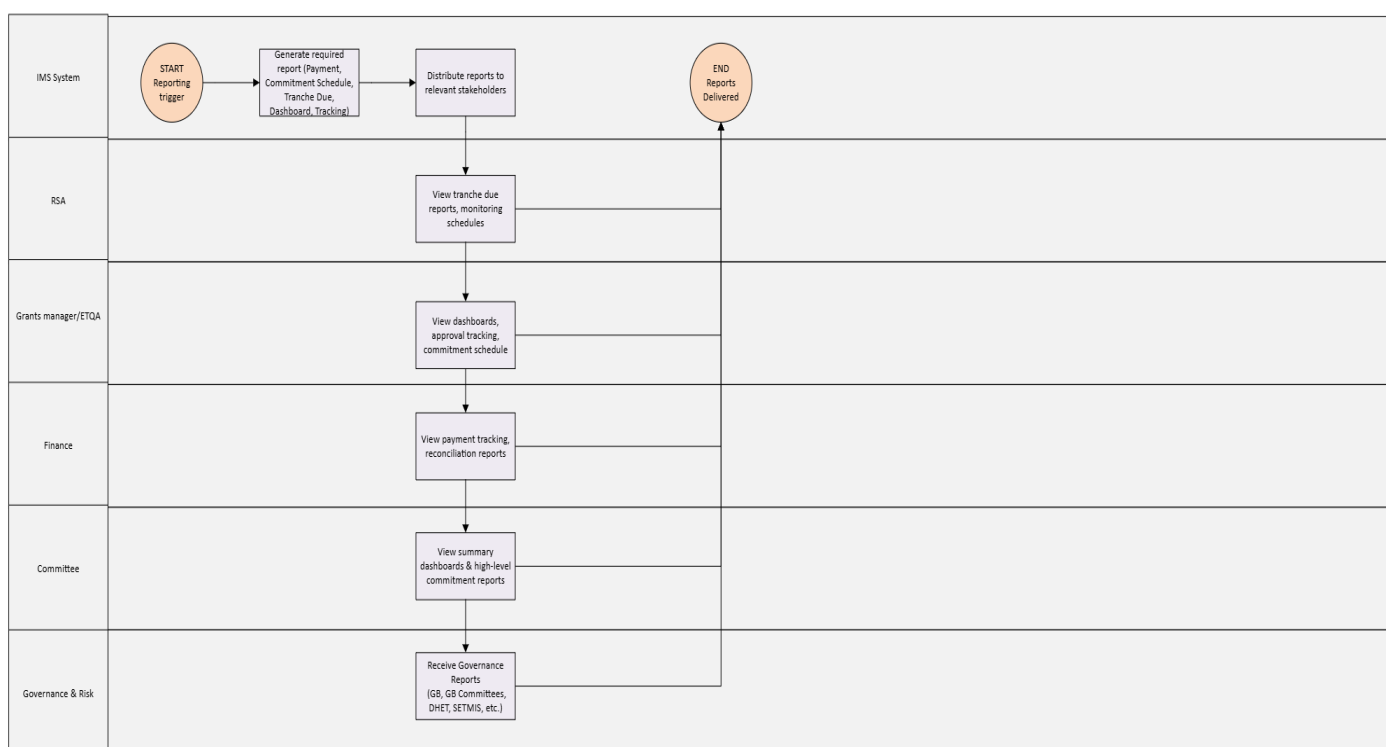
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NOTIFICATIONS & ALERTS



REPORTING



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FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

1. Funding Window

Funding windows are periods where stakeholders (SDFs, employers, skills development providers training providers and stakeholders) can apply for Discretionary Grants. The IMS must allow the Grants Unit to configure, manage, and monitor funding windows digitally.

Requirements

- Ability to for grants manager to create and configure funding windows:
 - Name (e.g., DG2025-2026 Cycle1).
 - Select project type of grants(Strategic, learning, research)
 - Start and end dates.
 - Optional Budget ceiling (linked to Board-approved budget).
 - Select focus area and sub-categories and interventions.
- Flexibility to open multiple funding windows during a year.
- Ability to edit funding parameters before launch (categories, interventions, dates).
- Approval by executive.
- Automatic alignment of funding windows to SLA, SSP, Qualifications and ETQA modules.
- Facility to send bulk email notifications to stakeholders about new windows:
 - Send to SDF, CEOs and senior representatives.
 - Select stakeholder type (DG, MG, SSDD, etc.).
 - Use pre-defined templates (advert/standard letter).
 - Update the CHIETA app and IMS dashboards.
- Integration with budgeting module: ensure allocations do not exceed approved ceilings.
- Reporting on open, closed, upcoming windows with budget utilization

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Requirements

- System must enable end-to-end management of Discretionary Grant (DG) award processes aligned to the CHIETA DG Awards SOP.
- Include workflow controls for each defined stage:
 1. Advertise and call for applications
 2. Application submission and eligibility screening
 3. Regional evaluation and due diligence
 4. Grants Evaluation Committee (GEC) review
 5. Grants Adjudication Committee (GAC) approval
 6. System preparation and MOA readiness
 7. Notification of results (award or rejection)
 8. MOA release and funding initiation
- System should provide role-based workflow assignment, notifications, and status tracking across all eight stages.
- Incorporate document management for adverts, evaluation reports, GEC/GAC minutes, and Board approvals.
- System must allow configuration of timeframes and deadlines per stage (as specified in SOP 01, section 7).

Business Rules

- A funding window cannot exceed the approved ceiling.
- Applications may only be submitted within the open window dates.
- Extensions can be granted to approved stakeholders (system must support extension requests).
- Each window must be linked to SLA/APP targets.
- Each window must be linked to the SLA/APP, strategic projects, and national priority targets.
- System must link all ETQA related applications to the Qualification, SDP, Workplace, Assessment Centres/Trade Test Centres.
- SDP Accreditation and Workplace Approval period must not be less than 12 months during application process.
- Approved Workplace must only be visible to an SDP that is linked on the ETQA system through a Service Level Agreement (SLA).

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2.1 SDF\stakeholder Registration & Company Linking

SDFs (Skills Development Facilitators) and stakeholder must be registered and linked to organizations where applicable before applications are submitted.

Requirements

- **New SDF/organisational representative registration:**
 - Username & password setup
 - OTP verification email
 - Biographical info (incl. ID).
 - Upload ID or passport.???
 - Verify ID with home affairs

The IMS must accommodate multiple stakeholder registration pathways:

- **SDL-based registration:** For levy-paying employers and SDFs (auto-validation via SDL lookup).
- **Non-SDL registration:** For research providers, NGOs, and individuals without SDL numbers (validated via organizational documents or identification uploads).
- **Institutional users:** Including universities, research partners, and government agencies linked via organizational profiles.

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- **Linking SDFs to organizations:**

- Are you a levy paying company?
- If yes – enter SDL/unique number
- If no – enter registration number
- Search for company
- If found then link, select SDF designation(primary or secondary)
- If not found capture organisation details
- Uploads required: appointment letter(to be verified during approval process)

- **SDF management:**

- Allow for multiple secondary SDF who can not finalize submission
- When a primary SDF leaves the company, the new SDF will initiate a change request and upload new appointment letter.
- Change request goes to Regional administrator for approval
- When approved, delink old SDF and link new SDF

- **Business Rules**

- No duplicate levy numbers.
- Company can only have one primary SDF at a time

2.2 NON-SDF DG APPLICANT REGISTRATION & PROJECT APPLICATION PROCESS

2.2.1) Non-SDF Applicant Registration (Strategic Projects / Research / Qualifications Development)

IMS must support the registration and application process for DG projects that do not require SDFs or learner-based workflows.

a) Applicant Categories

The system must allow registration of the following non-SDF applicant types:

- Independent researchers
- Universities and TVET/HET institutions
- Qualification development experts
- Consulting firms
- Industry specialists
- Organisations participating in Strategic Projects

These applicants are not required to have SDL numbers and must be able to register as standalone users.

b) Registration Process

The IMS must provide a dedicated “Non-SDF Applicant Registration” process including:

- Individual/Organisation Name
- Identification or Organisation Registration
- Contact details
- Expertise area (Research / Qualifications Development / Strategic Projects)
- Document uploads (CV, Company Profile, ID, Portfolio, etc.)
- OTP-based account creation

No SDF verification or company linkage is required.

2.2.2) DG Project Application (Non-Learner-Based Grants)

The IMS must allow non-SDF applicants to apply for DG projects that do not include learners. Application templates must reflect:

A. Qualification Development Projects

Project proposal fields must include:

- Project Title
- Deliverables
- Unit cost per deliverable
- Project Timeframes
- Total Project Cost
- Human Resources involved

B. Research Projects

Project proposal fields must include:

- Research Title
- Research Scope
- Methodology
- Literature Review
- Data Gathering Plan
- Data Analysis Approach
- Reporting structure
- Budget and Cost Breakdown
- Timeframes
- Human Resources

C. Upload & Submission

Applicants must upload proposals and supporting documents and submit directly into the IMS.

2.2.3) Evaluation Workflow for Non-SDF DG Projects

The workflow is:

1. RSPU Specialist Review
2. RSPU Manager Approval
3. Grants Manager Review
4. Grants Executive Recommendation
5. GEC Review
6. GAC Approval
7. MANCO Review
8. Grants Committee Final Approval

Each stage must have:

- Digital routing
- Automated notifications
- Ability to return applications for corrections
- Audit trail and timestamps

2.2.3) Contract Management and Tranches (Non-Learner Projects)

- Generate MOAs based on project deliverables, not learners
- Include deliverable-based milestones
- Define payment schedule per deliverable
- Allow assignment of project managers (RSPU / Relevant Unit)
- Track deliverable completion and evidence
- Manage contract amendments
- Support closure reports and final evaluations

The IMS must allow:

- Tranche creation per deliverable
- Review and sign-off by RSPU before payment request reaches Finance
- Upload of deliverable evidence
- Tracking of progress against project milestones

Payment workflow:

RSPU → Grants Manager → Grants Executive → Finance → CFO → Payment

3. DG Applications & Evaluations

Stakeholders apply for DG funding through IMS. Applications are evaluated and recommended by Regional offices, Committees, and Grants units.

Requirements

- Application submission:
 - Select learning programme, sub-category, ((Specific to ETQA related programmes (Learnerships - learning programme, sub-category, intervention, Skills Development Provider, Approved Workplace)).
 - Legacy (to be phased out in 2027/2029)
 - (RPL Artisan Related, RPL Non Artisan Related, Learnerships Enrolment 18.1 and 18.2, Apprenticeships Enrolments 18.1 and 18.2,
 - New
 - Occupational Qualification Enrolment Trade Related 18.1 and 18.2, Occupational Qualification Non Trade related 18.1 and 18.2), CHIETA related Skills Programmes 18.1 and 18.2), Part Qualification Enrolment 18.1 and 18.2. Occupational Qualification RPL Artisan related 18.1 and 18.2, Occupational Qualification RPL Non Artisan Related 18.1 and 18.2)
 - Capture required details.
 - Upload supporting documents. ((For ETQA related programmes please make provision for SLA between SDP and Workplace).)
- Regional Administrator notified of submission.

A. Evaluation Process

The IMS must support the full evaluation process, including:

- Allocation of applications to RSAs or relevant departmental staff.
- Compliance checks:
 - Company registration
 - BEE status
 - Tax clearance
 - Bank confirmation letter
 - Declaration of interest
- Capacity checks:
 - Accreditation
 - Workplace approval
 - Learner capacity
- Site visits for new companies, and desktop reviews for existing stakeholders.
- Scoring based on evaluation criteria.

B. Committee Approval Workflow (GEC → GAC → MANCO → Grants Committee → Board)

The IMS must digitally support the complete approval chain, including:

1. **Grants Evaluation Committee (GEC)**
 - Evaluates all eligible applications.
 - Submits recommendations to GAC.
2. **Grants Adjudication Committee (GAC)**
 - Reviews GEC recommendations.
 - Submits approved allocations to MANCO and the Grants Committee.
3. **MANCO Review**
 - MANCO reviews the GAC-approved list.
4. **Grants Committee Approval**
 - Approves allocations for Board ratification.
5. **Board Ratification**
 - Confirms final awards.

C. System Workflow Requirements

The IMS must:

- Digitally route applications through all approval stages:
 - RSA/Regional Recommendation → GEC → GAC → MANCO → Grants Committee → Board.
- Maintain approval logs, timestamps, comments, and responsible officials.
- Pre-populate outcomes from each previous stage.
- Support variable tranche configurations (more than 3) for Research, ETQA, and Strategic Projects.
- Capture all approvals, rejections, and committee decisions in the IMS.

D. Appeals

The IMS must support appeals processing:

- Stakeholders may submit appeals through the system.
- Appeals are routed to the Grants Executive for review and decision.
- All appeal decisions must be logged and stored for audit.

Business Rules

- Applications outside open funding window not accepted.
- Missing or invalid documents may result in rejection.
- Non-CHIETA organizations must upload workplace approval.
- Final approval by Grants Committee.

4. Change Requests & Appeals

IMS must provide a facility for stakeholders (SDFs) to request changes to approved contracts or appeal rejected applications. This ensures transparency, proper tracking, and auditability of post-award adjustments.

Requirements

- Company initiates a change request (within 60 days of award).
- Regional Skills Advisor (RSA) receives system alert, reviews, and recommends change.
- Regional Manager validates alignment with SQMR pipeline and budget implications.
- SQMR Specialist reviews and prepares addendum.
- Grants Specialist verifies and ensures data accuracy in IMS.
- Grants Manager reviews financial implications and signs off.
- Executive Manager approves and escalates to CEO.
- CEO provides final approval and digital signature.
- IMS updates commitment schedule and archives signed addendum.

Business Rules

- Overall contract value must remain same or lower.
- Appeals must be lodged within defined timeframe.

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5. MoA & Contract Management

IMS must generate, manage, and track Memoranda of Agreement (MoAs) for approved applications, ensuring contractual compliance before payments are made.

Requirements

- MoA generated per approved application/intervention.
 - Option to generate single MoA for multiple interventions.
 - Electronic signatures supported (if feasible).
 - Notifications to SDF to download and sign.
 - Upload of signed MoA, bank verification template, and bank letter.
 - RSA verifies uploads before payment initiation.
 - IMS must auto-generate MOA templates pre-populated with approved application data and linked budget details.
 - The system should allow tracking of MOA submission within 30 days and flag non-compliance.
 - MOA deliverables and award letters must be uploaded and version-controlled within IMS.
 - Include an automated notification to Regional Managers and RSAs when MOA status changes (from pending to signed).
 - The IMS must enable stakeholders and CHIETA users to initiate, review, and approve **MOA change requests** directly through the system.
-
- The system must allow a **formal “Change Request” module** that captures:
 - Type of change (qualification name, level, project type, continuation/new, etc.)
 - Reason for change (dropdown and free-text option)
 - Supporting documentation (upload field).
 - Automated alerts must be sent to relevant roles (RSA → Regional Manager → SQMR → Grants Manager → Executive Manager → CEO) according to approval hierarchy.

- Each change request must be timestamped, version-controlled, and tracked through all approval stages.
- MoA generated per approved application/intervention.
- The IMS must generate **auto-populated Addendum forms** based on approved change requests.
- System to update linked commitment schedules and project data once addendum is signed and finalized.
- Requests submitted after the 60-day post-award period must trigger a system warning and require Executive override.

MOA Extension Process

- The IMS must allow **stakeholders (SDFs/companies)** to submit an MOA extension request at least **two months before the expiry date**.
- Requests must include:
 - MOA number
 - Original expiry date
 - Reason(s) for the extension
- **System must automatically notify** the Regional Skills Advisor (RSA) and Grants Unit when an extension request is submitted.
- **Regional Manager** to review and approve the regional submission list one month prior to the scheduled Grants Committee.
- **Grants Unit** to:
 - Review all requests for compliance, completeness, and alignment to project timelines.
 - Consolidate approved requests into a **Grants Pack** for submission to MANCO and the Grants Committee.
- **Executive Manager** to present the final report to MANCO and Grants Committee for approval.
- **Upon approval:**
 - System generates an **addendum** for CEO sign-off.
 - **Grants Specialist** uploads the addendum to IMS and updates the **commitment schedule** automatically.
 - **RSA** notifies stakeholders and ensures all parties have signed the addendum.

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Business Rules

- No payments triggered without signed MoA.
- MoA must align with contract number generated.
- Extension requests must be received **no later than two months before the MOA expiry.**
- The system must **prevent duplicate or overlapping extensions** for the same MOA.
- **Only approved addendums** trigger reactivation of project timelines and tranche tracking.
- All updates must sync with **Finance and Commitment Schedules.**

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6. Tranche Payments (1a, 1b, 2, and/or 3)

IMS must automate tranche-based grant payments, ensuring that evidence is captured, verified, and approved through both Grants and Finance workflows.

Requirements

- Tranche 1a: triggered by MoA signing. Real Time learner status update from the ETQA system for ETQA related programmes only- This is specific to Continuing learners).
- Tranche 1b: Triggered by learner enrolment and evidence upload as per DHET validation guidelines and TIDs. (Real Time learner status update from the ETQA system for ETQA related programmes only)
- Tranche 2: triggered by mid-term progress reports and monitoring.
- Tranche 3: Triggered by completion evidence (certificates, SORs, close-out and monitoring reports, attendance registers) as per DHET validation guidelines and TIDs.
- Upload and verification process: SDF → RSA → Grants Practitioner → Grants Specialist → Grants Manager → Grants Executive → Finance.
- Finance approval workflow: Finance Admin → Specialist → Manager → CFO.
- (Discussion of system calculation with finance)
- Integration with SAGE for payment processing.
- Remittance advice uploaded to IMS for SDF access.
- POP's will be uploaded as a batch to which GMU will have access to distribute to stakeholders

- IMS must enable a structured workflow for payment processing in alignment with the Grants Payment SOP.
- Payment process to include 7 defined workflow stages:

1. Regional Skills Advisor – receives invoices, verifies documents.
2. Regional Manager – reviews and approves requisitions.
3. Regional Administrator – consolidates approved requisitions.
4. Grants & Projects Specialist – creates payment batches and reconciles.

- Each workflow stage must have **role-based access, timestamps, and task status visibility**.
- The system must generate and store **batch lists and banking files** automatically after final approval.
- Payment status (pending, verified, batched, approved, paid) must be visible to both Grants and Finance users.
- The IMS should automatically **flag overdue payments** exceeding the 25-working-day limit.

Business Rules

- Payment requests missing required evidence or documents cannot proceed.
- Payment batches must be reconciled against commitment schedules before approval.
- Each payment must carry a unique system-generated batch ID and remittance number.
- Payment documents (MOA, invoices, registers, reports) must be version-controlled and archived.
- System should not allow payments to more than total contract value.

No	DELIVERABLE	OBLIGATION	TRANCHE NUMBER	TRANCHE PERCENTAGE
Tranche 1a Deliverables (15%)				
1	Grant claim form/Invoice	Company	1a	15%
2	Signed MOA	Company	1a	15%
3	DG Initiation Letter	Company	1a	15%
Tranche 1b Deliverables (45%)				
1	Grant Claim Form / Invoice	Company	1b	45%
2	Detailed Project Plan	Company	1b	45%
Tranche 2 Deliverables (40%)				
1	Grant Claim Form / Invoice	Company	2	40%
2	Register with names of schools and learners traced	Company	2	40%
3	Detailed report with findings, analysis, and recommendations of the impact conducted on career guidance activities	Company	2	40%

(Above is the CG project tranche deliverables)

7. Sweeping Unused Funds

IMS must allow reallocation (“sweeping”) of unused committed funds when learners drop out or contracts underperform, to ensure budget optimization.

Requirements

- The IMS must include functionality to **identify, recommend, and approve sweeps (decommitments)** of unutilized or unclaimed DG funds in accordance with MOA deliverables.
- The system must allow **automated sweep initiation** triggered by inactivity, expired project timelines
- IMS must integrate sweeping updates with Finance to reflect changes in available budgets.
- Commitment Schedule and DG funding dashboards must auto-refresh post-sweep.
- Maintain linkage between original MOA and sweep record for full traceability.
- Users (RSA, Regional Manager, Grants Unit) must be able to log, review, and approve sweeps directly within the system.
- Sweeps must automatically update the **Commitment Schedule**, reflecting adjusted allocations and available funds.
- The workflow must capture sweep reasons, supporting documents, approval hierarchy, and timestamps.
- Work flow:
- RSA identifies possible sweep based on MOA deliverables or project plan.
- RSA liaises with stakeholder, confirms amount, and completes digital sweep form.
- Regional Manager reviews and approves the recommendation.
- Grants Specialist updates the commitment schedule.
- Grants Manager verifies and recommends to the Executive Manager.
- Executive Manager provides final approval.
- IMS must integrate sweeping updates with Finance to reflect changes in available budgets.
- Commitment Schedule and DG funding dashboards must auto-refresh post-sweep.
- Maintain linkage between original MOA and sweep record for full traceability.

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Business Rules

- Sweeping requires Grants Executive approval.
- Sweeps can only be initiated after the relevant project milestone deadline has passed.
- Sweeps require justification and stakeholder acknowledgment.
- Swept funds must be automatically reflected as “Available for Reallocation” in the funding dashboard.
- All approvals must occur within a 7-day turnaround to avoid project reporting delays.

8. Grant Financial Management

Requirements

- The IMS must provide functionality to **initiate, track, and manage recoveries** for disbursed DG funds due to non-compliance, underperformance, or early termination.
- The system must allow the **Regional Skills Advisor (RSA)** or **Specialist** to trigger a “Recovery Action” directly linked to the original MOA.
- Recovery records must include reason for recovery, amount to be recovered, recovery method (direct payment or offset), and supporting documentation.
- Once a recovery is initiated, the system must automatically alert the **Regional Manager, Grants Manager, and Grants executive** for approval workflow.
- Finance must be able to **raise a debtor record** automatically upon approval.
- The system must allow batch reporting and reconciliation with Finance on a quarterly basis.

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Work flow:

- RSA/Specialist identifies recovery need (triggered by non-compliance or incomplete deliverables).
- RSA drafts a digital recovery notice with reason, amount, and payment details.
- Regional Manager reviews and approves the recovery notice.
- RSA sends system-generated recovery letter to stakeholder.
- Finance receives recovery details to raise a debtor entry.
- Grants Specialist updates the commitment schedule to reflect the recovery.
- Grants Manager consolidates recovery data and submits a quarterly, monthly reconciliation report to Finance and Executive Manager.

Business Rules:

- Recovery can only be initiated for disbursed amounts linked to verified non-performance or MOA breach.
- All recovery notices must be approved by the Regional Manager before being sent to stakeholders.
- The system must block duplicate recovery records against the same MOA.
- All recovery cases must be closed only after proof of repayment or successful offset has been uploaded.
- Recovered amounts automatically adjust the available commitment schedule balance and budget utilization reports.

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9. Monitoring & Evaluation

IMS must support structured monitoring and evaluation of funded projects to verify learner progress and compliance.(developed into system)

Requirements

- Upload of progress reports, logbooks, stipend proof.
- The IMS must integrate the existing Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system, ensuring all functionalities and workflows are retained within the IMS environment.
- The integration must allow users to access M&E dashboards, data entry forms, approval routing, and reporting tools directly through the IMS interface.
- The M&E workflow (Data Capturer → Manager → M&E Specialist → Executive) must remain intact, supporting review, verification, and approval routing as in the current system.
- The IMS must automatically synchronize performance indicators, targets, and actuals between IMS and M&E modules to maintain data consistency.
- Integration must retain version control and change log functionality, recording the user, date, and reason for any change to indicator data or performance evidence.
- All M&E performance data, documents, and evidence uploaded must be linked to their corresponding projects, MOAs, or strategic initiatives in the IMS.
- The system must support real-time dashboards and disaggregated reporting for all business units (Grants, ETQA, Research, and Projects).
- The integration must include AGSA and DHET reporting compliance, ensuring performance evidence and indicator data are audit-ready.
- The IMS must eliminate the need for manual data capture or duplication between the IMS and the standalone M&E platform.
- The system must allow for future M&E enhancements or tool updates without affecting existing data integrity or reporting functions.

Business Rules

- Non-compliant submissions sent back to stakeholder

10. Notifications & Alerts

IMS must automate communications to stakeholders and CHIETA staff to improve compliance with deadlines and reduce delays.

Requirements

- Automatic notifications for:
 - Window opening.
 - Application submission.
 - MoA signing due.
 - Tranche evidence submission.
 - Payment approvals.
 - Monitoring visits.
 - Contract close-out.
- Configurable templates for bulk and system emails.

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11. Reporting

IMS must provide robust reporting and dashboards to track applications, payments, learner and project progress, and compliance, supporting management decisions and SLA reporting, where applicable.

Requirements

- Payment Report: batch payments.
- Movement per Contract: balances and reconciliations.
- Tranches Due Report: outstanding tranches.
- Commitment Schedule: grant commitments vs. expenditure.
- Dashboard: summary of tranches due, progress, commitments.
- Performance reporting to Governance, aligned with SETMIS, SQMR, and GB Committees.

Business Rules

- Reports must align to SLA and APP targets.
- All reports must be auditable and based on live data.

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12. Performance Management & AoPO

IMS must automate and track the end-to-end performance evidence lifecycle to ensure alignment with CHIETA's APP, Grants performance targets, and AGSA audit requirements.

Functional Objectives

- Ensure complete and accurate performance reporting across all APP indicators.
- Automate data collection, verification, and aggregation for AoPO reporting.
- Support quarterly and annual audit processes (internal and AGSA).
- Link each APP indicator to its corresponding funding window, DG project, and learner evidence.

System Workflow Requirements

1. Planning and Setup

- IMS to store and manage the approved **Annual Performance Plan (APP)** with all indicators, targets, and responsible units.
- Funding windows and DG adverts must automatically link to APP indicators.
- Each application and MOA must reference the relevant APP indicator.

2. DG Application to Approval Alignment

- IMS must capture the DG process end-to-end — from **advertisement** → **evaluation (GEC/GAC)** → **approval and MOA generation**.
- All approved projects must map directly to APP indicators within the IMS, ensuring clear traceability.

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TABLE INDICATING TRANCHE PAYMENTS /EVIDENCE AGAINST ENTERED AND COMPLETED

INDICATOR	TRANCHE 1B (Entered)	TRANCHE 2	TRANCHE 3 (Completed)	COMMENTS
L/ships	✓	✗	✓	
Apprenticeships	✓	✗	✓	
WIL TVET	✓	✗	✓	
WIL HET	✓	✗	✓	
WIL Internships / UoT	✓	✗	✓	
ARPL /RPL	✓	✗	✓	
Skills Programmes	✓	✓	✓	
AET	✓	✓	✓	
Candidacy	✓	✗	✓	
COOPs & NGOs	✓	✓	✓	

INDICATOR	TRANCHE 1B	TRANCHE 2	TRANCHE 3	COMMENTS
SMME	✓	✗	✓	
Partnerships	Tranche 1A	✗		
Bursary's	✓	✓		

7. DHET and AGSA Reporting Integration

- IMS must export validated learner and project data in a **DHET Edukativ-compliant format**.
- Database Specialist (ICT) must verify SETMIS uploads before transmission.
- Feedback from DHET or AGSA (accept/reject, exceptions, duplicates) must be imported into IMS for tracking and correction.

8. Continuous Assurance and Audit Trail

- Every change to performance data (entered, completed, removed) must be version-controlled.
- IMS to store:
 - Original evidence files
 - Validation results
 - Correction audit logs
 - AoPO feedback status (e.g., “Pending Validation,” “Rejected,” “Accepted”)
- Governance unit must have dashboard access to all open and resolved audit findings by region and indicator.

Business Rules

1. No learner or project may be reported against multiple indicators or quarters.
2. Each indicator must have predefined means of verification in the system linked to upload types.
3. Invalid or missing ID numbers must block reporting until corrected.
4. System must detect and flag duplicates across regions and learning programmes.
5. All tranches must align with MOA timelines and APP targets.
6. Only verified “Completed” records count towards AoPO reporting.

FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Mandatory Grants

1. MG Funding Window Setup

The IMS must allow the Grants Manager or Research Specialist to configure Mandatory Grants windows with the following parameters:

- Ability to open the window anytime between November and February (due to OFO changes).
- Capture:
 - Window Start Date
 - Window End Date (default: **30 April**)
 - Extension Request Window (01–22 April)
 - Approved Extension Submission Window (01–31 May)
 - Funding Window Name using naming convention: **MG + Year**
- Ability to send **bulk notification emails** to:
 - MG applicants
 - DG applicants
 - SSDD applicants
- Option to select which group receives communication.

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2. Stakeholder and SDF Registration

The IMS must support MG applications for:

- Levy-paying companies
- Non-levy-paying / tax-exempt companies (generate **N-number**)
- Non-CHIETA levy-payers (L-number sourced from DHET)
- Any organisation applying for MG (NGOs, colleges, etc.)

New SDF Registration

- Capture:
 - Personal details + ID
 - Contact information
 - No document uploads required
- System generates Username + Password
- Email/OTP verification
- SDF dashboard loads with **no linked companies**.

Existing SDF

- Login using existing credentials.

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3. Add Organization to SDF Profile

New Organisations

System must support:

- Capturing organisation details
- Auto-pull levy info from SARS/DHET when SDL is entered
- Allow SDF to update:
 - Organisation address
 - Bank details
- Upload:
 - Appointment Letter
- Allow SDF to start MG application.

Existing Organisations

- SDF searches and links organisation.

If an SDF already exists:

Dispute Resolution Process

System must:

1. Trigger SDF Dispute when two SDFs attempt to manage the same organisation.
2. Lock both SDFs until resolved.
3. Notify both SDFs + Regional Administrator.
4. Allow upload of new appointment letters.
5. Enable Regional Administrator to:
 - Select the valid SDF
 - Unlock only the approved SDF profile

4. MG Application Capture

System must allow SDFs to capture:

- Application details (according to template)
- Bank details (with notification for Grants Accountant to verify)
- Document uploads:
 - Bank confirmation letter
 - Signed submission
- Submission of complete application

Notifications must be sent to:

- Regional Administrator when an application is submitted
- SDF when bank details are rejected

5. Extension Requests

- Must be submitted online during 01–22 April.
- IMS must consolidate extension requests for regional and Grants Committee review.
- Grants Committee can:
 - Approve individual extensions
 - Approve entire batch
- Once approved → system auto-opens extension window (01–31 May).

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6. MG Evaluation Workflow

MG Evaluation must support the following user activities:

RSA / Administrator

- View submitted applications
- Validate documents:
 - Bank confirmation
 - Signed submission
 - Biographic data
- Tick “Complete” / “Incomplete”

System Rules:

- If incomplete **before 30 April / 31 May** → Notify SDF to fix
- If incomplete **after deadline** → Automatic “Not Approved”

Regional Manager

- Review and recommend region batch
- Can override RSA recommendation with comments

Grants Manager

- Review consolidated region recommendations
- Override with comments
- Recommend to Grants Executive

Grants Executive

- Final recommendation to Grants Committee
- Can reject and send back with comments

Grants Committee

- Reviews stats by sector, region
- Approves full batch
- Final authority

System must:

- Notify RSA/Administrator + SDF of approvals/non-approvals
- Generate approval letters and non-approval letters

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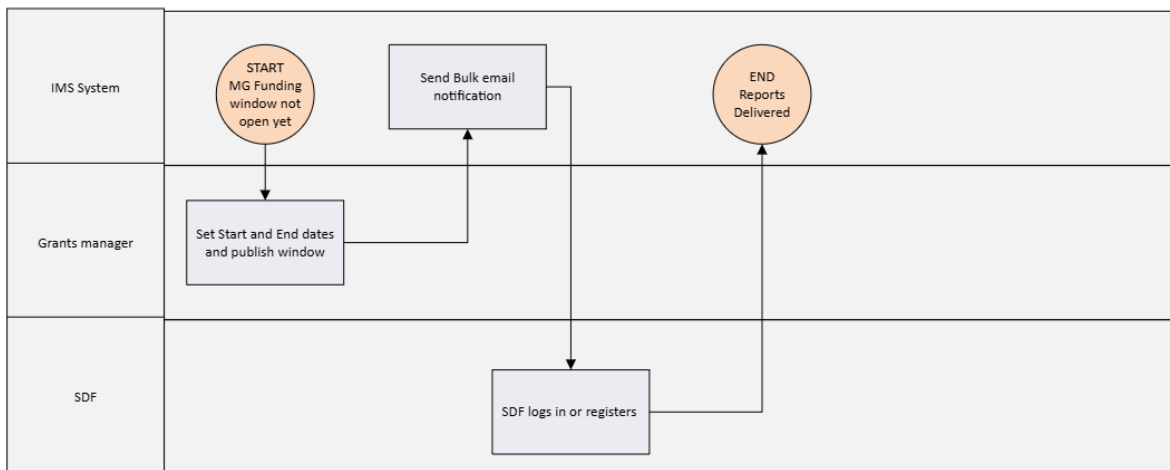
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7. MG Payments – Business Rule

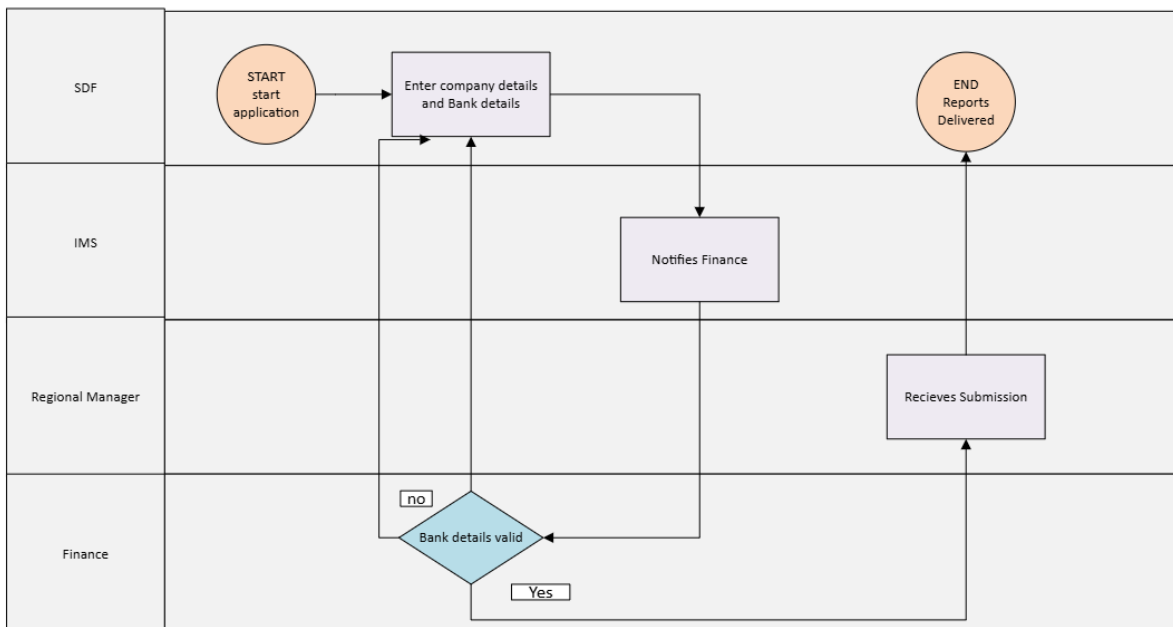
System must implement the following MG business rules:

1. **Required Templates:**
A reporting template must be finalised before MG window opens (Grants + Research).
2. **Stakeholder Communication:**
Bulk email must be available at any time.
3. **Application Period:**
Stakeholders may only apply within window dates.
4. **Extensions:**
System must support an extension mechanism.
5. **SDF Assignment:**
One SDL number = one SDF.
6. **Duplicate Checks:**
 - Duplicate levy numbers must trigger an error.
 - Non-registered companies must have unique registration numbers.
7. **Mandatory Fields:**
Application must fail if:
 - Biographical data incomplete
 - Bank details not verified
 - Signed submission missing
8. **Previous Biographical Data Import:**
SDF may import prior-year data and update.
9. **Post-Submission Lock:**
 - SDF cannot edit application after submission
 - RSA may assist with edits during verification phase

MG Funding Window



MG Application Capture



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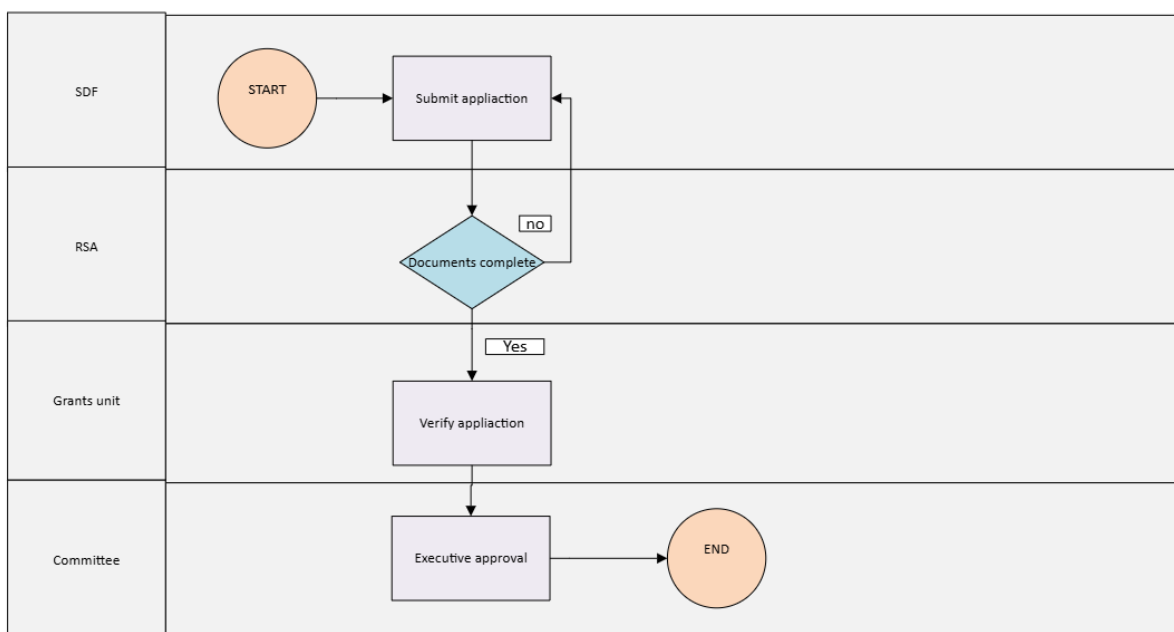
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MG Evaluation



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NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

. Performance

- The system must support at least 500 concurrent users without performance degradation.
- Average page response time should not exceed 3 seconds under normal load.
- Batch processing of applications and payments should complete within 2 hours.
- System must scale to handle growth in users and data volumes for at least 5 years.

2. Security & Compliance

- Must comply with PoPIA for protection of personal information.
- Must comply with PFMA for management of public funds.
- Role-based access control (RBAC) with strict segregation of duties:
 - SDFs/ stakeholders → applications and uploads only.
 - RSAs/ other role players → evaluations and monitoring.
 - Finance → payment processing and verification.
 - Executives → approvals and reporting.
- Secure storage and transmission of sensitive data (encryption in transit and at rest).
- Audit logs for all system activities (who, what, when).

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3. Usability

- Simple, user-friendly web interface accessible via modern browsers.
- Guided workflows with system prompts and help text.
- Multilingual support (English, possibly other official SA languages if required).
- Mobile responsiveness for stakeholder access via phones/tablets.
- Accessibility compliance (screen readers, font scaling).

4. Availability & Scalability

- System availability must be 99.5% during business hours.
- Cloud-hosted or CHIETA data centre with failover and disaster recovery.
- Daily backups with minimum 30-day retention.
- Ability to scale horizontally (more servers) or vertically (bigger servers) based on usage.

5. Maintainability

- Code must comply with CHIETA's Software Development Standards.
- Documentation (technical & user) must be updated with each release.
- Modular design to allow new funding windows or programme types to be added without redesign.

INTEGRATION & DATA REQUIREMENTS

1. Home Affairs (ID Validation)

- Integration with Department of Home Affairs to validate learner ID numbers.
- Must verify: full name, date of birth, ID status (valid/invalid).
- Real-time validation required during learner registration.

2. QCTO / SETA (Learner Qualifications)

- Integration with QCTO/SETA databases to confirm learner qualifications and training provider accreditation.
- Ability to upload or pull accreditation details for providers.
- Cross-check learners against SETA accreditation for funded programmes.

3. Finance System (SAGE Integration & Reconciliation)

- Integration with SAGE for payment processing.
- Generate CSV or API-based imports for payments.
- Import remittance advices from SAGE into IMS,
- Real-time reconciliation between Regional Offices and Finance team.
- Finance will grant access to GMU.
- Integrate with ICT for funding window setup and application platform access.
- Enable data exchange between IMS and Board reporting modules for approval tracking.
- Link MOA status and award data to Finance for commitment scheduling and expenditure ceiling control.
- IMS to integrate with Finance (SAGE) for:
 - Importing payment batches after Executive approval.
 - Exporting payment confirmation and remittance details back to IMS.
 - Synchronizing supplier information between SAGE and IMS.
 - Verifying total payment against contract value (validation rule).
- Finance must have access controls to verify remittance uploads before disbursement.
- Audit trail to record all payment-related actions and user activities.
- Enable integration for **Recovery Transactions** between IMS and Finance (SAGE) for automatic debtor creation and reconciliation.

4. OCR for Document Validation

- Optical Character Recognition (OCR) required to validate uploaded documents (e.g., bank confirmation letters, ID copies, certificates).
- System must flag mismatched or invalid documents for review.

5. SETMIS Reporting

- Automatic generation of SETMIS reports once tranches are completed (enrolment + completion).
- Reporting fields aligned to Department of Higher Education and Training standards.
- Disaggregated reporting, including learner personal contact information aligned with RSPU requirements.

6. DHET (Department of Higher Education & Training)

- IMS reports funding commitments, disbursements, and learner data to DHET (SLA compliance).
- DHET provides policy/targets (not transactional).

7. SAQA

- IMS validates learner qualifications against SAQA records.

8. NAMB

- IMS validates apprenticeships, trade tests, and artisan registrations.
- Disaggregated reporting, including learner personal contact information aligned with RSPU requirements

9. NSFAS

- Cross-checks learners already funded through NSFAS (avoid double funding).

10. Department of Employment & Labour / UIF

- Cross-check learner employment/unemployment status.

11. SASSA

- Validate if learner is receiving social grants (important for unemployed beneficiary checks).

12. National Skills Fund (NSF)

- IMS reports discretionary grant funding utilisation.
- May also align on co-funding of projects.

12. Online assessment (ETQA/Research)

The IMS must integrate with the Online Assessment Platform (developed by UJ), supporting:

- Deployment on CHIETA's internal environment.
- Digital and paper-based assessments under invigilation.
- Secure login for assessors and learners.
- Upload and tracking of assessment results and evidence.
- Ownership of source code and independent system management post-transfer.

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Business Rules

1. Categories/sub-categories to be funded are determined annually and approved before window opening.
2. IMS must allow selection of approved categories and addition of new ones if required.
3. Applications can only be submitted within the official funding window start and end dates.
4. Approved stakeholders may be granted extensions (system must allow extension requests).
5. One SDL number may only be linked to one SDF.
6. Levy numbers must not be duplicated.
7. If mandatory fields are marked “No”, the application fails automatically.
8. If Tranche 1b and Tranche 2/3 payments are complete, SETMIS reporting is required.
9. Tranches:
 - **Tranche 1a** – triggered on MoA signing.
 - **Tranche 1b** – triggered by learner enrolment with supporting evidence.
 - **Tranche 2** – triggered by mid-term learner progress (6–8 months).
 - **Tranche 3** – triggered by learner completion and certification.
10. SDF and stakeholders appointment validation required to block unauthorized access.
11. Regional Administrators must have the ability to reallocate tasks between RSAs.
12. Tranche documents may be submitted in any order.
13. Tranche structures vary by programme type:
 - Skills Programme, Bursaries, RPL → Tranches 1 & 2.
 - Learnership, Apprenticeship, WIL → Tranches 1, 2, & 3.

14. Learner replacements must be managed via ETQA processes, and learners must be registered.
15. Partial payments must be supported within a tranche.
16. Mixed tranche payments (multiple tranches in one batch) must be supported.
17. Certification/SOR triggers close-out grant processing.
18. Learner enrolment triggers Tranche 1b processing.
19. IMS must generate task lists for contracts due for mid-term or close-out.
20. Change Requests can only be submitted **within 60 days** of the DG award date.
21. Any changes beyond that period require Executive override approval.
22. System must prevent submission if required supporting evidence is missing.
23. Only the CEO's approval can finalize and version-lock the new MOA.
24. Addendums must be automatically numbered (e.g., MOA/CHG/2025/001).
25. Changes must not compromise SQMR targets or budget allocations.

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REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

The IMS must generate real-time and scheduled reports for Grants, Regional Offices, Finance, and Executives.

- AoPO (Achievement of Performance Objectives): AGSA performance audit framework
- DHET SETMIS uploads: for verified learner and project data
- AGSA compliance reports: using validated indicators and supporting documentation
- Quarterly MANCO and Board packs: combining Grants, Research, and ETQA updates

1. SETMIS Reporting

- Automatic generation of SETMIS submissions once Tranche 1b and final tranches are complete.
- Must align with Department of Higher Education and Training (DHET) data format.
- Disaggregated reporting, including learner personal contact information aligned with RSPU requirements

2. Movement per Contract

- Track contract balances and payments against approved MoA value.
- Show committed vs. paid amounts per contract.
- Must reconcile with Finance system (SAGE).

3. Payment Reports

- Show payments processed per batch.
- Include MoA reference, tranche type, date, stakeholder, and amount.

4. Payment Tracking & Reports

The IMS must provide detailed tracking of payments across all tranches and processes, ensuring transparency, accountability, and reconciliation between Grants and Finance.

Requirements

- **Payment Workflow Tracking**
 - Track status from SDF submission → RSA verification → Grants approvals → Finance approvals → CFO sign-off.
 - Show pending tasks, completed steps, and bottlenecks.
 - Include timestamps and responsible users for each step.
- **Audit Trail**
 - Maintain full audit log of payment evidence uploads, approvals, rejections, and resubmissions.
 - Must be exportable for audit purposes.
- **Reports**
 - Payment Tracking Report: progress of payments through workflow.
 - Payment Batch Summary: all contracts included in each batch, with amounts.
 - Remittance Report: import remittance advices from SAGE and link to relevant MoAs/contracts.
 - Exception Report: highlight stalled, rejected, or overdue payments.

Business Rules

- Payments cannot proceed if required approvals are missing.
- Evidence must be verified at each stage before advancing.
- Remittances must be stored in IMS and accessible to stakeholders.
- Reconciliation with SAGE is mandatory before final approval.

5. Tranche Due Reports

The IMS must generate reports showing which tranches (1a, 1b, 2, 3) are due for payment, based on contract milestones and supporting evidence. This ensures timely disbursement and compliance with APP/SLA targets.

Requirements

- Report must list:
 - Contract/MoA reference number.
 - Employer/SDF name.
 - Programme type (Learnership, Apprenticeship, Skills Programme, Qualification development, research, career guidance, Bursary, etc.).
 - Tranche type (1a, 1b, 2, 3).
 - Due date for submission/payment.
 - Status of evidence (submitted, pending, rejected).
 - RSA/Region responsible.
- Filter options:
 - Region
 - Programme type
 - Funding window
 - Tranche type
- Export options: Excel and PDF.
- Automatic notifications for overdue tranches.

Business Rules

- Tranche reports must be based on signed MoAs and approved learner schedules.
- Due tranches must align with contract timelines (initiation, enrolment, mid-term, close-out).
- Reports must update in real-time as evidence and approvals are submitted.

6. Commitment Schedule

The Commitment Schedule is a report that tracks CHIETA's grant commitments against the approved annual budget, ensuring allocations do not exceed Board-approved ceilings.

Requirements

- Show committed amounts per contract, programme, and funding window.
- The IMS must allow for **automated commitment schedule updates**, reconciliations, and quarterly reporting with electronic sign-offs.
- Users should be able to generate, review, and approve **regional and consolidated commitment schedules** within the system.
- Commitment schedule data must auto-pull from approved payments, recoveries, sweeps, and MOA adjustments.
- System must track **quarterly submissions** by region and send automated alerts for pending reconciliations or sign-offs.
- Track payments made against commitments.
- Show available balance (budget – commitments – payments).
- Ability to filter by:
 - Region
 - Funding window
 - Programme type
 - Employer/SDF
- Must align with SAGE finance system for reconciliation.
- Export to Excel and PDF.

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System Functions

- **Update & Consolidation:** Grants Specialists update and reconcile regional submissions with processed invoices.
- **Verification:** Grants Manager reviews for completeness and financial accuracy before submission.
- **Approval & Sign-Off:** Regional Managers and Executive Manager electronically sign-off consolidated quarterly commitment schedules.
- **Integration:** Commitment data must sync with Finance and Reporting modules for audit and dashboard visibility.
- **Audit Trail:** Each sign-off and edit must be time-stamped and traceable to the approving user.

Workflow

- RSAs update regional commitment schedules quarterly.
- Regional Administrator coordinates commitment schedule meetings based on the Executive Manager's calendar.
- Grants Unit conducts reconciliation with regional offices and project managers (Research, Qualification Development, Career Guidance).
- Regional and project managers submit their quarterly reports through the IMS.
- Grants Manager verifies and signs-off the final commitment schedule with regional managers.
- Executive Manager provides final quarterly approval and releases the report for Finance and Audit.

Business Rules

- All commitment schedules must be submitted and approved within five working days of quarter-end.
- No disbursement or adjustment may occur if the previous quarter's commitment schedule remains unsigned.
- Only authorized users (Grants Manager, Regional Manager, Executive Manager) may approve schedules.
- The IMS must retain all historical versions of commitment schedules for reference and audit.

7. Dashboards

The IMS must provide interactive dashboards for executives, managers, and administrators to monitor key grant management metrics in real time.

Requirements

- Dashboard Views
 - Real-time status of projects, assessments, and research studies.
 - APP and AoPO indicator progress tracking.
 - Disaggregated data views (by unit, project type, or region).
 - Automated notifications for:
 - Qualification expiry
 - Pending tranches or milestones
 - Missing evidence uploads
 - Learner and stakeholder contact lookup for follow-up and compliance.
 - Executive Dashboard: high-level KPIs (total applications, approvals, commitments vs. budget, payments processed, tranches due).
 - Research Dashboard: SSDD, M&E related for instance (project monitoring)
 - Regional Dashboard: region-specific applications, evaluations, tranches, and payments.
 - Finance Dashboard: payment workflow status, pending approvals, reconciliation with SAGE.
 - Grants Unit Dashboard: application volumes, funding window utilization, appeals/change requests.
- Filters
 - By region
 - By programme type (Learnership, Skills Programme, Bursary, etc.)
 - By funding window/cycle
 - By tranche type
- Visualizations
 - Graphs (bar, line, pie) for applications, commitments, and payments.
 - Heatmaps for regional performance.
 - Trend lines for learner enrolment and completions.
- Export & Sharing
 - Export dashboard snapshots to PDF/Excel.
 - Shareable links within IMS for management meetings.

Business Rules

- Dashboards must refresh in real time (or near real time, max 15-minute delay).
- Only authorized users may view dashboards (role-based access).
- Dashboard data must align with official SLA/APP reporting.

USER JOURNEYS & USE CASES



This section outlines the main user interactions with the IMS, capturing end-to-end workflows for key roles.

1. Stakeholder Application (SDF)

Journey

- Register/login as SDF.
- Link to employer organisation.
- Apply for DG funding during open window.
- Upload required documents.
- Regional Office screens and performs due diligence.
- Grants Manager coordinates GEC evaluation session on IMS.
- GEC records scores and recommendations.
- GAC reviews and ratifies funding recommendations.
- Executive Manager submits report to Manco and Board for final approval.
- IMS generates award letters and MOAs.
- Stakeholders receive notifications and project activation commences.

Use Case

- Actor: SDF
- Goal: Submit a DG application.
- Preconditions: Funding window open, SDF registered and linked to organisation.
- Postconditions: Application logged in IMS, Regional Administrator notified.

2. RSA Monitoring

Journey

- Receive application allocation from Regional Administrator.
- Review and verify uploaded documents.
- Conduct desktop/site visit checks where required.
- Capture evaluation scores and recommendations.
- Record monitoring results (learner interviews, progress reports, close-out evidence).

Use Case

- Actor: RSA
- Goal: Evaluate application or monitor contract.
- Preconditions: Application submitted and allocated.
- Postconditions: Evaluation results recorded in IMS, recommendations sent to committee.

3. Finance Payment Approval

Journey

- Receive payment batch from Grants Unit.
- Flag changed bank details
- Integration with SAGE and import payment batch from bank
- Import of suppliers from SAGE
- Upload remittance advice to IMS for SDF access.

Use Case

- Actor: Finance Administrator/**Specialist**/Manager/CFO
- Goal: Approve grant payment.
- Preconditions: Payment batch submitted.
- Postconditions: Payment executed in SAGE
- **Remittance submitted to grants.**

4. RSA Monitoring

Journey

- Receive application allocation from Regional Administrator.
- RSA uploads invoice package with supporting evidence.
- Regional Manager reviews and approves.
- Regional Administrator consolidates and submits to Grants Unit.
- Practitioner validates MOA alignment and deliverables.
- Specialist reviews, reconciles, and creates payment batch.
- Grants Manager verifies completeness and forwards to Executive Manager.
- Executive Manager approves and submits to Finance.
- Finance processes payment and updates remittance advice.
- System closes batch and archives supporting documentation.

Use Case

- Actor: RSA, Regional Manager, Regional Admin, Grants Practitioner, Grants Specialist, Grants Manager, Executive Manager, Finance

5. Executive Reporting

Journey

- Access dashboards.
- Review budget utilization, commitments, payments, learner progress.
- Drill down by region, programme type, or funding window.
- Export dashboard snapshots for board/committee meetings.

Use Case

- Actor: Grants Executive / CEO / Committee Member
- Goal: Monitor performance and approve strategic decisions.
- Preconditions: IMS live data available.
- Postconditions: Reports used in governance meetings.

6. Change Requests

Journey

- SDF initiates a change request on an approved contract (e.g., update
- Company logs into IMS and initiates a “Change Request” from their awarded MOA.
- System notifies RSA to review the request.
- RSA verifies and submits for Regional Manager approval.
- Regional Manager reviews SQMR implications and approves.
- SQMR Specialist prepares addendum in IMS.
- Grants Specialist checks for system-generated addendum accuracy and forwards.
- Grants Manager reviews financial impact and submits to Executive.
- Executive Manager reviews and escalates to CEO for final approval.
- CEO signs addendum digitally; IMS locks the record and updates the MOA status.

Use Case

- Actor:
- Goal: Modify or withdraw a grant contract.
- Preconditions: Valid contract exists; SDF has system access.
- Postconditions: Contract updated or request rejected; audit log recorded.

7. Appeals

Journey

- SDF submits an appeal if an application is rejected.
- Capture appeal details in IMS.
- IMS notifies the Grants Manager.
- Grants Manager reviews submission and forwards to Grants Executive.
- Grants Executive makes decision to approve or reject the appeal.
- IMS updates application status and notifies the SDF.

Use Case

- Actor: SDF / Grants Manager / Grants Executive
- Goal: Request reconsideration of a rejected application.
- Preconditions: Application must have been evaluated and rejected.
- Postconditions: Appeal outcome recorded in IMS; SDF notified.

8. Notifications & Alerts

Journey

- IMS generates notifications automatically when key events occur (application submission, MoA ready, tranche evidence required, payment processed, committee agenda scheduled).
- Notifications are routed to the correct stakeholder (SDF, RSA, Finance, Executives).
- Stakeholders receive alerts via IMS and/or email.
- Stakeholders act on the notification (upload documents, approve request, attend committee, etc.).

Use Case

- Actor: IMS (System), SDF, RSA, Finance, Executives
- Goal: Ensure all stakeholders are informed of required actions and deadlines.

9. Reporting & Monitoring

Journey

- IMS generates scheduled and ad-hoc reports (payment tracking, tranche due, commitment schedule, dashboards).
- RSAs access tranche due reports and monitoring schedules.
- Grants Managers and Executives review dashboards for decision-making.
- Finance reviews reconciliation and payment tracking reports.
- Committees/Board members access summary reports for governance.

Use Case

- Actor: RSA / Grants Manager / Executives / Finance / Committees
- Goal: Access timely, accurate reporting to support monitoring and governance.
- Preconditions: IMS data available and up to date.
- Postconditions: Reports distributed and used for operational and strategic decision-making.

9. DG Fund Recovery Process

Journey

- RSA/Specialist identifies non-performance and initiates recovery on IMS.
- Regional Manager reviews and approves.
- Grants Manager validates and forwards for Executive Manager approval.
- Finance receives recovery details, raises debtor entry, and confirms receipt of payment.
- Grants Specialist updates commitment schedule and attaches POP.
- IMS auto-closes recovery case once full recovery is confirmed.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA & UAT

UAT Approach

- User Acceptance Testing (UAT) will be conducted by functional business users (Grants Unit, RSAs, Finance, Executives).
- Testing will occur in a separate UAT environment, isolated from production.
- Test cases will be derived from business requirements and user journeys defined in this BRD.
- UAT will focus on validating:
 - Functionality against requirements.
 - Data accuracy (applications, payments, learner records).
 - Workflow correctness (approval sequences, notifications).
 - Integration with external systems (SAGE, SETMIS, Home Affairs, QCTO).
 - Usability and performance under expected load.

Success Criteria

- All critical (“Must Have”) requirements (MoSCoW = M) are tested and passed.
- No open high-severity defects remain at UAT sign-off.
- UAT sign-off provided by:
 - Grants Unit (application workflows, evaluations, contracts).
 - Regional Offices (RSA monitoring, allocations).
 - Finance (payments, reconciliation with SAGE).
 - Executives (dashboards, reporting).
- System demonstrates compliance with CHIETA Software Development Standards.
- Training material and user guides are reviewed and accepted

RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation Strategy
Delays in integration with external systems (SAGE, Home Affairs, QCTO, SETMIS).	Payment processing, learner validation, and reporting may be delayed or incomplete.	Medium	Early engagement with system owners, formal SLAs for integration, phased rollout with manual backup processes.
Incomplete or inaccurate stakeholder applications.	Evaluations delayed, higher rejection rate, reputational risk.	High	Enforce system validation rules, mandatory fields, and automated compliance checks before submission.
Budget ceilings exceeded due to incorrect allocations.	Non-compliance with PFMA, audit findings.	Low	System-enforced budget caps, automated reconciliation with Commitment Schedule.
User resistance to new system (preferring Excel/manual).	Low adoption, parallel manual processes continue.	Medium	Change management plan, stakeholder training, phased onboarding, continuous support.
Data privacy breaches (learner personal information).	Legal risk (PoPIA), reputational damage.	Medium	Encryption, strict role-based access, audit logs, penetration testing.
Payment delays due to evidence verification bottlenecks.	Stakeholder dissatisfaction, learners unpaid.	High	Clear workflow escalation, automated reminders, dashboards for pending approvals.
ICT resource constraints during development and support.	Project delays, reduced quality.	Medium	Allocate dedicated ICT team, outsource where required, follow CHIETA Software Development Standards.
Changes in DHET/SETA compliance requirements.	IMS non-compliant with legislation and reporting standards.	Medium	Continuous regulatory monitoring, modular system design for adaptability.
Poor data quality (duplicate learners, incorrect IDs, invalid documents).	Incorrect reporting, payments to ineligible learners.	High	ID validation with Home Affairs, OCR document validation, system duplicate checks.

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TECHNICAL STANDARDS

Technical Stack

- **Database:** Microsoft SQL Server – structured storage of applications, contracts, learners, and payments.
- **Backend:** .NET Core – business logic, APIs, workflow orchestration.
- **Frontend:** Angular – responsive web interface for SDFs, RSAs, Finance, and Executives.
- **Integration Layer:** RESTful APIs and batch interfaces for third-party systems (SAGE, Home Affairs, QCTO, SETMIS).
- **Supporting Tools:** Python (OCR for document validation, data analysis scripts).

System Architecture Principles

- **Modular Design:** Separated functional modules (Applications, Evaluations, Payments, Monitoring, Reporting).
- **Scalability:** Horizontal scaling to handle peak loads during grant application windows.
- **Security:**
 - Role-based access control.
 - Data encryption in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest.
 - PoPIA and PFMA compliance.
- **Auditability:** Full audit trail for all user actions (submission, approval, payment).
- **Availability:** High-availability setup with daily backups and disaster recovery plan.
- **Integration:** Secure APIs for real-time and batch data exchange.

Compliance with CHIETA Software Development Standards

- Coding and documentation standards as per “**Software Development Standards Ver 1.01 – Mobile App CHIETA**”.
- Mandatory peer code reviews and version control (Git).
- Automated testing: unit, integration, and regression.
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT) before production release.

APPENDICES



Appendix A – SOP Reference

- **Document:** *1.5 SOP for Payment Processing*
- Summary: Outlines the current step-by-step process for DG payment approvals, including finance checks and tranche processing.

Appendix B – Meeting Notes Summary

- **Document:** *IMS Meetings*
- Summary: Key discussion points, challenges, suggestions, and open questions from stakeholder engagements.

Appendix C – Software Development Standards

- **Document:** *Software Development Standards Ver 1.01 – Mobile App CHIETA.pdf*
- Summary: Defines coding, testing, and deployment standards to ensure quality and maintainability.

Appendix D – Source Documents

- **DG Grant Requirements 31052022_DG1.0.3.docx** – detailed requirements for discretionary grants.
- **Grants Processes.pdf** – mapped process flows of current grants.

EDITS:

- Which info needs to be confidential – ask stakeholders?
- Tester? – 1 person per business unit to test development phase. This trains them to get back to their team and share the training.
- Learn traceability matrix.
- Be detailed about integration – at what point does it come in, what's goes in between the integration.

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